

BOUTAHRI PRODUCTIONS

**THE PERFECT JOSEPH AND GUMBALL
THE MULTIVERSAL SAGA**

PART THREE: THE BREAKING POINT

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"From one weakness was born infinite power."

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COLD OPEN: THE COST OF EVERYTHING

EXT. CASABLANCA – RUE DES ORANGERS – DAWN – PRESENT DAY

The jasmine on the south wall of the cream-colored building is still growing.

This is the first thing to understand about jasmine: it does not stop because something has happened. It grows because it grows. It smells like September because September is when it smells like this. It has been growing on this wall for thirty years and it will grow on this wall after today.

JOSEPH AL-MITHALI (20) stands on the street and looks up at the building. The fourth floor. The window of his mother's kitchen – which is now simply a window.

He has been standing here for eleven minutes. He knows this because he counted.

He is about to go inside for the last time before he leaves for the In-Between. He is about to water the plants and lock the door and give the key to Khadija next door – who has been bringing his mother tea on bad days for twenty years and who said, without being asked: of course. It was always hers anyway. I was just helping.

He is about to do all of this. First he stands on the street for eleven minutes and looks at the building.

The jasmine sways. The morning call to prayer has ended. The city begins its day with the specific indifference that cities have – the indifference that is not cruelty but simply the fact that cities contain too many things to pause for any one of them.

Joseph takes a breath. He gives it three honest seconds. One. Two. Three.

He goes inside.

CUT TO:

INT. AL-MITHALI APARTMENT – FATIMA'S KITCHEN – CONTINUOUS
The kitchen.

CLOSE ON: the ficus on the window ledge. Eleven years old.
Still alive. It needed water. He watered it. It is fine.

The two smaller succulents beside it. Also fine. He
watered those too.

The Quran on the bookshelf. Her handwriting in the margins
– the notes she made about specific verses, the date she
wrote them, her precise careful hand that is also Nadia's
hand and also, now that he looks, something of his own
hand.

The photographs. Him and Nadia at various ages. The
wedding photograph he had not seen before he came here
after. The photograph from Fez where she is mid-sentence –
caught in a moment of pure being, not performing anything
for the camera. Just being herself completely.

The kettle that makes a specific sound when it boils.
Nadia has taken it. He can hear it sometimes when he calls
her from the kitchen window of his temporary apartment
three streets away. The sound carries the way his mother's
voice carried – without effort, as if it knew it had
somewhere important to be.

Joseph sits at the kitchen table. He has his spiral
notebook. Moroccan flag sticker – faded but present.

He opens it. He writes one line:

**Be water. Not hard. Not brittle. Water bends and comes
back.**

He closes the notebook. He puts it in his backpack.

He stands. He looks at the kitchen one more time.

He does not say goodbye. Goodbye would make it smaller
than it is. He simply looks. He gives it the specific look
of someone who is going to carry this place with them for

the rest of their life and wants to make sure the inventory is accurate.

The inventory: the ficus. The Quran with her handwriting. The photograph from Fez. The sound the kettle would make. The way the morning light comes through that window at exactly this angle at exactly this hour and does not repeat itself precisely until next year.

He has it. It is accurate.

Then he goes.

The jasmine on the south wall catches the morning light. It sways, slightly, in a breeze that has come from the Atlantic three kilometers west and is going somewhere north of here.

On the windowsill, the ficus leans imperceptibly toward the sun. As it has always done. As it will continue to do.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. MAXIMUM SECURITY FACILITY – EPSTEIN'S CELL – UNKNOWN DIMENSION – NIGHT

A cell that is almost not a cell. Clean lines. Sparse. One narrow window through which dimensional distortion makes the outside world look slightly wrong – the trees too symmetrical, the sky one shade off from blue.

JEFFREY EPSTEIN (50s) – BILL SKARSGÅRD – sits at a small desk. He writes nothing. He has no paper. He is writing in his mind. His stillness is not peace. It is compression. The stillness of stored energy.

CLOSE ON: his eyes. Patient. Working. The eyes of a man who has waited before and found that waiting, when done correctly, is simply another form of action.

GUARD #2
(at cell door, taunting)
Still planning, Jeffrey? Two years
and you're still staring at walls.

Must be nice, having all that
big-brain energy and absolutely
nowhere to put it.

Epstein does not move. A beat of silence so total it has
texture.

EPSTEIN

(without turning)

I know three things about you that
you have not told anyone in this
facility. I know your daughter's
middle name, which is also your
mother's name. I know what you did
with the forty-three dollars you
skimmed from the commissary
account in March. And I know about
the conversation you had with
Commissioner Halley last Thursday,
in which you said certain things
about certain people that
Commissioner Halley has since
relayed to those people.

A beat. The guard goes very still.

EPSTEIN

(still not turning)

None of that information will
leave this room as long as you
understand something fundamental:
you are not the person in this
arrangement who has power over the
other. You are the door. I am what
moves through doors.

A long silence. The guard leaves. Fast.

Epstein turns back to his desk. He reaches beneath his cot
and produces a folded piece of paper – contraband,
acquired at cost. He unfolds it with the care of someone
handling something precious.

It is a hand-drawn diagram. Circles connected by lines. At the center of the diagram: a name.

JOSEPH AL-MITHALI.

Epstein studies it. His finger traces the lines radiating outward from that center. Each line terminates in a circle. Each circle contains a word.

MOTHER. SISTER. BEST FRIEND. THE BOY WITH THE BLUE HOODIE. THE WOMAN WHO BRINGS PASTRIES.

He taps the circle marked MOTHER. Once. Twice.

His expression does not change. His expression never changes.

EPSTEIN

(V.O.)

In the fifteen dimensions I moved through before this one, the pattern was always the same. Titles changed. Mechanisms adapted. But the architecture was invariant.

EPSTEIN

(V.O.)

Identify the nexus points. Become the infrastructure through which power flows. Make yourself necessary to everyone and accountable to no one. And when you find the one person who could actually stop you –

He stands. Moves to the window. The distorted outside world bends around his reflection.

EPSTEIN

(V.O.)

– you do not attack their armor. You remove what the armor is protecting.

He presses one finger against the cold glass. His fingerprint remains briefly. Then fades.

EPSTEIN

(V.O.)

Joseph's strength was not his power. Power is a fact but not the center. The center was his connections. The specific, irreplaceable, unchosen people who made him what he was. Those were the load-bearing elements.

EPSTEIN

(V.O.)

To strike them was not to weaken him physically. It was to hollow him structurally. To remove the elements that held everything else up – while the building continued to stand. For a while.

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. THE MULTIVERSE – THE VOID – ETERNAL

MUSIC: A single Arabic oud string, plucked once. It reverberates into silence.

ABSOLUTE DARKNESS.

Then – a single point of light. It breathes. Expands.

What we are seeing is not a star. It is a REALITY. One of countless realities, spinning slowly in the dark like an ember kept alive in ash.

Pull back. Another. And another. Thousands. Millions. An ocean of worlds, each one separated from the next by the thinnest membrane of dimensional pressure, all of them orbiting some impossible center.

The IMAX frame fills. This is not beauty – this is architecture. Ancient, enormous, and under terrible strain.

Hairline FRACTURES run between several realities. Like cracks in old porcelain. Like the stress lines in glass before it shatters.

FIFTEEN DIMENSIONS. ONE METHOD. ONE NAME.

The fractures pulse. One of them widens, just slightly. In the darkness between worlds, something moves. Something with purpose and patience and no mercy whatsoever.

THE BREAKING POINT

The title detonates across the frame in deep gold on black. No fanfare. Just the weight of the words.

MUSIC: The oud gives way to a low electronic pulse – barely audible, almost subsonic. Arabic strings enter beneath it, melancholy and deliberate.

Part Three of the Fracture Saga – In which the price of everything is paid.

FADE IN:

ACT ONE: THE ARCHITECTURE OF LOSS

EXT. MPA HEADQUARTERS – THE NEXUS POINT – DAWN

The building exists at the intersection of three dimensional planes. From the outside it looks like an ordinary structure – glass and steel, thirty stories, the kind of building that a city builds when it is trying to say something about itself.

From the inside, if you know where to look, you can see all fifteen dimensions simultaneously. Most people who work here have learned not to look.

Joseph's transport descends through low cloud. He watches the city come up to meet him through the window. His expression is the expression of someone doing inventory – noting what is still present, what has changed, what is not there anymore.

SEIKO TOAST (19) – JAHZIR BRUNO – is waiting on the landing platform when the transport doors open. He is wearing the blue hoodie. He is holding two cups of coffee. He is doing the thing where he pretends to be checking his phone so he has somewhere to put his eyes while he waits.

Joseph steps out. Seiko looks up. Neither of them says anything for a moment.

SEIKO
(handing him coffee)
Ethiopian blend. Remembered you
take it without anything.

JOSEPH
(taking it)
How long have you been out here?

SEIKO
Seven minutes. Which is how long
the transport took from the

Moroccan dimensional gate plus
estimated walking time from the
transfer station.

Joseph looks at him.

JOSEPH
You calculated when I would arrive
so you could be out here already.

SEIKO
(looking at his phone)
I'm very efficient.

A beat. Joseph drinks the coffee. It is correct.

JOSEPH
Thank you.

SEIKO
Anytime.

They stand there for a moment in the early morning. The
city below them. The dimensional planes shifting slowly in
the air around the building like light through water.

A man and a boy who chose each other, which is the only
kind of family that requires sustained decision.

SEIKO
(quieter)
How are you?

Joseph looks at the city. A long breath.

JOSEPH
I watered her plants. I gave the
key to Khadija. I took the
photograph from Fez.

SEIKO
That's not what I asked.

JOSEPH
I know.

Another beat.

JOSEPH
I'm water. Working on the bending
part.

Seiko nods. He does not push. He knows when not to push.

SEIKO
When you're ready. We have things
to show you.

JOSEPH
How bad?

SEIKO
I would say medium bad but I would
be describing it incorrectly. It
is quite bad.

Joseph takes another sip of coffee.

JOSEPH
Then let's go inside.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA COMMAND CENTER — CONTINUOUS

The command center occupies five floors simultaneously. Screens cover every surface. Analysts move between stations. In the center of it all, a holographic display shows all fifteen known dimensions — some stable, some marked with the amber warning color of dimensional stress.

YARA GORDON (21) — JORDYN RAYA JAMES — stands at the central display. She has not slept. She works in the specific way of someone who has decided that sleep is something that happens to other people in other circumstances.

GUMBALL WATTERSON — animated, rendered in performance-capture that makes him look simultaneously real and impossible — sits at a secondary console eating cereal from a bowl he has somehow acquired. DARWIN stands

beside him, looking at data with an expression of genuine distress.

GUMBALL

(mouth full)

Joseph! You're back. Good. We've been waiting. Well, I've been eating. Darwin's been worrying. Yara's been doing that thing where she doesn't blink.

DARWIN

(not looking up)

I blink. I just blink efficiently.

YARA

(turning from display)

The fractures have accelerated by thirty-eight percent since your departure. Dimension Seven is now at critical stress. Dimension Twelve shows signs of sympathetic fracturing – which means if Twelve goes, it takes Four and Nine with it.

JOSEPH

(studying display)

Timeline?

YARA

Seiko's models give us eighteen days before cascade failure. But that's without accounting for Kronos accelerating the fracture rates deliberately, which we have to assume he will.

JOSEPH

So.

YARA

So we might have eleven.

Joseph stares at the display. The amber zones pulse.
Beautiful and terrible.

SEIKO
(from his station)
There's something else. Something
I found three days ago that I've
been triple-checking before
telling anyone.

He brings up a new set of data. Different from the
fracture mapping – older looking, almost archaeological.

SEIKO
There's a substance called Weezy
Gold. Pre-dimensional. Older than
the current dimensional
architecture. Theoretical until
now – I found a signal.

He projects a dimensional coordinate. Deep in what the
maps label the Amber Dimension.

SEIKO
According to every piece of
ancient dimensional theory I've
been able to find – and I've been
able to find quite a lot – Weezy
Gold is the only substance capable
of sealing dimensional fractures
from the inside. Not patching
them. Actually sealing them.
Permanently.

JOSEPH
How certain are you?

SEIKO
About the theory? Ninety-four
percent. About the signal I found?
One hundred.

GUMBALL
(setting down cereal)

What's the catch? There's always a catch. Darwin, there's a catch.

DARWIN
I'm aware there's a catch.

SEIKO
The Amber Dimension is... not stable. It's crystallized time – a region where multiple timelines collapsed into each other and solidified. It's navigable, but only by someone who has experience with dimensional chaos. Someone with a very specific kind of compass. Someone, theoretically, like –

JOSEPH
Like who?

Seiko looks at him with the look of someone about to say something they expect to be received badly.

SEIKO
There's a man. Captain. Operates out of the Dimensional Port of Elsinore. He's navigated the Amber Dimension before. He is the only person in fifteen dimensions who has navigated it before and returned.

YARA
(dry)
He's also a pirate. A compulsive liar. And according to three separate dimensional jurisdictions, a wanted fugitive.

JOSEPH
What's his name?

SEIKO
Sparrow. Captain Jack Sparrow.

GUMBALL

Beat.

I love this job.

CUT TO:

INT. THE TEMPORAL DOMAIN – KRONOS'S THRONE – OUTSIDE OF
TIME

A place that should not exist. It exists anyway.

It looks like a cathedral made of clocks – not in a whimsical sense but in a functional one, every surface covered in the mechanisms of time, each one marking a different dimension's temporal flow, each one running at a different speed.

KRONOS – GIANCARLO ESPOSITO – stands with his back to us, watching a prisoner on his knees: a minor dimensional bureaucrat named TESSLER who has the unfortunate distinction of having tried to block Kronos's access to Dimension Seven's temporal controls.

Tessler's hands are shaking.

KRONOS
(without turning)
Tell me what you understand about
time.

TESSLER
(barely)
I – it... moves forward. It
doesn't go back.

KRONOS
(turning now)
Correct. And incorrect. Time moves
forward because it is constrained
to do so by the dimensional
architecture. The architecture is
not a law. It is an agreement. A

very old agreement made by
entities that no longer exist,
enforced by inertia. The agreement
can be renegotiated. I am the only
one with the leverage to do so.

TESSLER
(very small)
What are you negotiating for?

KRONOS
(almost kind)
Stillness. I have watched fifteen
dimensions cycle through their
birth and death and birth and
death and I am very, very tired of
the cycle. I want the moment
before anything happens, preserved
indefinitely.

TESSLER
(barely)
That would kill everyone.

KRONOS
(gently)
Yes. But very peacefully.

He raises one hand. The clocks around them all stop
simultaneously. The silence is absolute.

Then EPSTEIN is brought in. Not in shackles. He walks in
and looks around with the mild professional interest of
someone assessing a new property.

EPSTEIN
(looking around)
You're a maximalist. Interesting.
I find that people who surround
themselves with the physical
manifestation of their power
usually have an unresolved
relationship with the possibility

of losing it.

KRONOS

(measuring him)

You've been in that cell for two years. I had you extracted because certain intelligence indicates you have specific knowledge about Joseph Al-Mithali's psychological architecture.

EPSTEIN

Of course you do.

KRONOS

Name your terms.

EPSTEIN

Full operational independence. Access to your temporal infrastructure – not the power, just the logistics. And remove Homelander's independent authority from the arrangement. He remains an asset, but answerable to me.

KRONOS

(carefully)

Homelander is powerful.

EPSTEIN

Homelander is powerful and undisciplined and constitutionally incapable of taking direction without visible resentment. He is a liability who has not yet stopped paying dividends. There is a distinction. He will at some point make a unilateral decision that costs you everything he gained you.

Kronos considers this. A long silence.

KRONOS
What do you get from this
arrangement?

EPSTEIN
(a thin smile)
I get to finish what I started.
Joseph Al-Mithali makes things
equitable. I find equitability
professionally offensive.

KRONOS
So you want revenge.

EPSTEIN
I want completion. There's a
distinction.

Kronos looks at him for a long, very long moment. The
clocks tick.

KRONOS
You have forty-eight hours before
Homelander's scheduled briefing.
Use the time well.

EPSTEIN
I always do.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — OBSERVATION DECK — NIGHT

GUMBALL and DARWIN stand at the observation glass looking
out at all fifteen dimensional planes visible from this
height. It's an extraordinary view. They've been here
before but it doesn't stop being extraordinary.

Darwin has his notebook. He's been writing something. He
closes it when he hears Gumball sit down beside him.

GUMBALL
(quiet, which is rare)
Darwin.

DARWIN

Yeah?

GUMBALL

Are you scared?

A pause. Darwin looks out at the dimensions.

DARWIN

Yes. You?

GUMBALL

Very. But I've been scared before
and things turned out okay.
Mostly. Some things didn't. But
mostly.

DARWIN

That's actually comforting in a
specific way.

GUMBALL

I'm a specific kind of comforting.
It's a gift.

A beat. Both of them looking at the dimensional display.

DARWIN

(quietly)

I've been thinking about what
Joseph said. About his mother.
About the jasmine that keeps
growing.

GUMBALL

Yeah.

DARWIN

There are people in all fifteen of
those dimensions who have their
own equivalent. Their own jasmine.
Their own kitchens. Their own tea
on bad days. And they just – they
don't know any of this is
happening. They're just going

about their lives hoping the sky
stays sky.

GUMBALL
(after a moment)
Then we make sure it does.

Simple. Darwin nods.

DARWIN
We make sure it does.

They sit there for a while in the observation deck, two
friends looking at fifteen dimensions they've decided to
protect, which is both enormous and exactly the right
decision.

CUT TO:

INT. NADIA'S APARTMENT – CASABLANCA – VIDEO CALL – NIGHT
NADIA AL-MITHALI (22) – MERYEM TOUZANI – sits at her
kitchen table. The kettle – their mother's kettle – is
visible behind her. She is on a video call with Joseph.
She has the look of someone who is managing more than she
is saying, which is the specific look she has had since
she was twelve years old.

NADIA
(in Arabic)
You look different.

JOSEPH
(in Arabic, from screen)
Different how?

NADIA
Like someone who's carrying
something very heavy and has
decided to be comfortable with
that instead of putting it down.

JOSEPH
(a small smile)
That's accurate.

NADIA
Are you eating?

JOSEPH
Seiko makes sure I eat. He
schedules it.

NADIA
Tell Seiko I said thank you.

JOSEPH
He'll be embarrassed.

NADIA
Tell him anyway.

A beat. The comfortable silence of people who know each
other's rhythms.

NADIA
(quieter)
Khadija called me. She said you
gave her the key.

JOSEPH
She said she was just helping.
That it was always Mama's anyway.

NADIA
(voice shifting
slightly)
That sounds like her.

JOSEPH
Yes.

Another beat.

NADIA
Joseph. Whatever you're doing –
whatever it is that's too
classified for you to tell me
about – I need you to know
something.

JOSEPH

What?

NADIA

She was proudest of you for the way you talk to people. Not the accomplishments. Not the title. The way you look at people when they're talking, like what they're saying is the most important thing in the room. She said: he got that from both of us.

A very long pause.

JOSEPH

(barely)

I didn't know she said that.

NADIA

She didn't say it to you. She said it to me. She said: don't tell him, it'll make him self-conscious.

The smallest sound – not quite a laugh, not quite something else.

JOSEPH

Of course she did.

NADIA

Come home when you can.

JOSEPH

I will.

NADIA

Don't just say that.

JOSEPH

(meaning it)

I will.

CUT TO:

INT. EPSTEIN'S SAFEHOUSE – DIMENSIONAL ANCHOR POINT – DAY
A pocket dimension. Three rooms, immaculate. EPSTEIN has been here for six hours and it already looks lived-in in the way his spaces always look lived-in: ordered, purposeful, everything in the service of thought.

MORRIS (40s) stands at a tablet, managing logistics with the anxiety of a man who has seen what happens when things aren't managed.

MORRIS
(nervous, as always)
The Maxwell contact has been re-established. The three operatives in Dimension Seven are in position. Your financial infrastructure across eight dimensions has been reconstructed to a thirty-two percent baseline –

EPSTEIN
(not looking up)
Forty-seven percent within the week. Tell the Dimension Three team to accelerate the Veritas account consolidation.

MORRIS
Yes. Also – he's coming.
Homelander. Twelve minutes.

EPSTEIN
(looking up)
Is he angry?

MORRIS
His tracking signature suggests significant agitation. Yes.

EPSTEIN
Good.

He closes whatever he's reading. He straightens the items on the desk – four seconds, everything perfectly ordered.

EPSTEIN
Wait in the other room.

MORRIS
There isn't really an outside –

EPSTEIN
Wait in the other room.

Morris goes. Epstein sits. He waits twelve minutes exactly.

At minute twelve, the entry point pulses. HOMELANDER – ANTHONY STARR – arrives. He does not arrive through a door. He lands through the roof. Which reassembles itself after him. He is wearing the suit. His cape is slightly singed.

CUT TO:

INT. EPSTEIN'S SAFEHOUSE – CONTINUOUS

– EPSTEIN vs. HOMELANDER: CONFRONTATION ONE –

HOMELANDER
(standing, not sitting)
You have a lot of nerve. Two years in a cell and you walk out and the first thing you do is send me a meeting request through Kronos's people like you're scheduling a conference call.

EPSTEIN
(placidly)
Sit down.

HOMELANDER
I don't sit when I –

EPSTEIN

You'll stand for the next twenty minutes if you prefer. But you'll still be here in twenty minutes because this conversation contains information you need. So sit down, or stand up, but let's proceed.

Homelander does something complicated with his face. He does not sit. But he stops moving.

HOMELANDER

I've been running this operation for two years. The arrangement with Kronos, the dimensional access, the asset network – I built that while you were making friends with guards in a box. You don't get to walk in and tell me how this works.

EPSTEIN

What you built was very impressive. You have excellent instincts for the acquisition of resources. You have considerably less instinct for what to do with them once you have them.

HOMELANDER

(cold)

Say that again.

EPSTEIN

You spent two years accumulating leverage and deploying it in ways that make you feel powerful and accomplish very little. You attacked Joseph's support network twice. Both times, he rebuilt. Because you attacked the structure without understanding the load-bearing elements.

HOMELANDER
His mother is dead.

A pause. Something shifts in the room's atmosphere.

EPSTEIN
(very quiet)
I'm aware.

HOMELANDER
He should be broken. He should be
on his knees. That's what happens
when you take away the thing that
someone —

EPSTEIN
Sit down.

The way he says it this time is different. Homelander
stops speaking.

EPSTEIN
You took away the person. You
thought the loss would hollow him.
What actually happened is that the
loss became what he carries. Do
you understand the distinction?

HOMELANDER
(narrowing eyes)
He should be in pieces.

EPSTEIN
He was in pieces. He put himself
back together using the thing she
told him. 'Be water.' Do you know
what that means? It means that the
very instrument you used to try to
break him became the structural
principle he rebuilt around. You
gave him his armor.
Congratulations.

Homelander stares. His jaw tightens. This is new information and he does not like new information.

HOMELANDER

So what are you saying? He's unbreakable now?

EPSTEIN

Everyone is breakable. The question is finding the break that the subject has not already fortified.

HOMELANDER

The boy. Toast.

EPSTEIN

(a small nod)

Seiko is closer than family. He is the friendship that Joseph chose. There is a specific kind of relationship – not blood, chosen, deliberate – that when severed creates a particular variety of wound. The kind that doesn't scar because it doesn't know how to close.

He looks at Homelander with something that is not quite respect but is in that neighborhood.

EPSTEIN

But we don't move on that now. Now we let them pursue the Gold. We let them think they're ahead. And then, when they're deep in the Amber Dimension and maximally isolated –

HOMELANDER

(understanding)

Maxwell.

EPSTEIN

Maxwell is already positioned. She will tell us exactly when they find the Gold, and we will be ready before they return.

HOMELANDER

And what do I do while you're orchestrating all this?

EPSTEIN

You maintain the pressure on the dimensional governments. Keep them destabilized. Every decision they make should feel like it has three bad options and no good ones.

HOMELANDER

That's cleanup work. You're giving me cleanup work.

EPSTEIN

(directly)

I'm giving you the work that uses your specific capabilities. You are extremely good at making people afraid. That is a distinct and valuable skill. I am using it in the place where it creates maximum strategic value.

Homelander's jaw works. He wants to say something sharp. He can't find anything that will land.

HOMELANDER

(controlled, dangerous)

You should be careful how you talk to me.

EPSTEIN

(simply)

You should be careful what you do in response to how I talk to you. You have leverage. I have

information. About you. About choices you've made. About what you want, which is more specific and more vulnerable than you've allowed anyone to understand.

A silence. Very long.

HOMELANDER
(barely audible)
Ryan.

EPSTEIN
You want him to see you as you want to be seen. Not as you are. That gap – between what you want and what you are – is the most precisely human thing about you. And it is the thing I will never tell anyone as long as our arrangement remains what it is.

The silence stretches.

HOMELANDER
(finally)
Fine. I'll do the destabilization.

EPSTEIN
Good. Don't kill anyone in Dimension Four – they're in a delicate political position and deaths create investigations. Investigations create documentation. Documentation creates trails.

HOMELANDER
(heading for exit)
Tell me something I don't know.

EPSTEIN
(as Homelander leaves)

You need me more than you'll admit
for the next eight to ten days.
After that – we'll see.

Homelander pauses at the exit. Does not turn.

HOMELANDER
Don't push it.

He leaves. The pocket dimension reassembles around his
exit point.

Epstein is alone. He looks at the space where Homelander
stood.

EPSTEIN
(to himself, very
quietly)
He has no idea.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA – MEMORIAL HALL – NIGHT

After everyone has gone home or to stations, Joseph walks
to the Memorial Hall. He does not tell anyone where he is
going.

The hall is quiet. Along the walls: photographs and names
and dates. People lost in the fracture events.
Dimensionals who didn't survive the collapse. A few from
before – dimensional workers who gave everything and were
never thanked for it.

Joseph walks slowly along the wall. He reads names. He
stops at one.

FATIMA AL-MITHALI. Beloved. Precise. 1956–2024. A small
photograph of her at the kitchen table in the apartment on
Rue des Orangers, mid-sentence. In the middle of saying
something that mattered.

Joseph stands before it. The hall is empty. He stands
there for a long time.

JOSEPH

(very quietly, to the
photograph)
I'm doing the water thing. I know
how it sounds. I'm doing it
anyway.

A breath.

JOSEPH
Epstein's out. Which means — I
know. I know what it means. I know
he's coming for what's left. I'm
trying to finish this before he
can.

He touches the edge of the photograph. Careful.

JOSEPH
I'm going to find this Gold. And
I'm going to seal the fractures.
And then I don't know what
happens. But those billions of
people in those fifteen dimensions
are going to have the chance to
have ordinary lives. Kitchens.
Jasmine plants on walls. Tea that
someone brings on bad days. The
specific ordinary things that are
actually extraordinary when
they're present and only
understood as extraordinary once
they're gone.

He straightens. He takes a breath that is not quite steady
and does not pretend to be.

JOSEPH
I'm going to give that to them.
And then — I'll figure out what
comes after.

He stands for one more moment. Then he goes to pack for
the Amber Dimension.

CUT TO:

INT. MAXWELL'S POSITIONED APARTMENT — DIMENSION SEVEN —
SAME NIGHT

GHISLAINE MAXWELL — RASHIDA JONES — is at a window,
looking down at a city that doesn't know she's here. She
has been in Dimension Seven for six weeks. In six weeks
she has built three relationships that look like
friendships and are intelligence assets.

She pours herself tea. She sits. She opens a
communications device and sends a status report to
Epstein:

**TARGET IS IN TRANSIT. GOLD RETRIEVAL IMMINENT. PLANT IS
PREPARED. AWAITING DEPLOYMENT INSTRUCTION.**

She sends it. She puts the device down. She looks at the
tea.

A longer pause than usual. She picks up a second device —
a personal one, not part of the operation. She looks at
it. Puts it down. Picks up the operation device again.

MAXWELL
(to herself, barely)
Six weeks. Six more weeks and this
is done.

She doesn't entirely believe that. She has been in this
business long enough to know that 'done' is not a stable
category. But she says it because saying it is a habit
that keeps things moving.

Outside the window, the city of Dimension Seven goes about
its night. Unaware. Jasmine equivalent growing on walls.
Tea being made. Specific ordinary things.

Maxwell watches it and does not let herself think about
what the fractures are doing to the people who live there.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — RESEARCH WING — DAY

YARA is meeting with DR. ELLISON – MAHERSHALA ALI – Harvard professor, dimensional ethics, the kind of academic who crossed into action because theory ran out of room.

ELLISON
The humanitarian frameworks we've been using were built for single-dimension crises. They don't scale to fifteen simultaneous fracture events. We're seeing gaps –

YARA
I know. I'm the one watching people fall into the gaps.

ELLISON
(measured)
I'm not criticizing. I'm saying we need new frameworks. Which requires time we may not have.

YARA
What would the new framework look like?

ELLISON
Cross-dimensional mutual aid networks. Each dimension's functioning populations supporting the ones under stress – with actual infrastructure, not just goodwill. Joseph's MPA as the coordinating body rather than the delivery body. Let local organizations deliver. MPA just ensures connectivity.

YARA
(processing this)
That's not how we've operated.

ELLISON

No. But it's how we should operate. The current model requires everything to flow through you. That's efficient until it isn't – and we are already past the point where it isn't.

Yara looks at the humanitarian data on her screen. Six hundred thousand displaced. The number that doesn't stop being a number.

YARA

If we restructure now – mid-crisis – we risk disrupting existing supply chains.

ELLISON

Yes. The alternative is maintaining a supply chain that is at forty percent capacity and declining.

A long pause.

YARA

(decision)

Build me the framework. Full proposal. I want it in eight hours.

ELLISON

(standing)

I can do six.

YARA

Good.

CUT TO:

EXT. PORT OF ELSINORE – DIMENSION NINE – DAY

The Port of Elsinore is what happens when fifteen dimensions have been trading with each other long enough

that the trading post becomes its own reality. It smells like salt water and dimensional static and the specific kind of commerce that does not ask too many questions.

Ships of every conceivable design dock here. Some are steel. Some are wood. One is a submarine. One is a flying vessel of unclear propulsion. And one is the BLACK PEARL – recognizable even here as a thing that does not quite belong and has never once allowed that to bother it.

Joseph and Seiko stand on the dock looking at it.

SEIKO

His last known location was aboard that vessel. Registered under the name 'Jacobsen.' Port records show he's been here three weeks.

JOSEPH

What did your records say about his personality?

SEIKO

(choosing words
carefully)

He is described by multiple sources as 'extremely capable,' 'completely unreliable,' 'somehow always alive despite everything,' and 'the only person to have returned from the Amber Dimension alive.' In that order.

JOSEPH

Great.

They board the Pearl. The deck is maintained in the sense that it is functional but not in the sense that anyone has cared about aesthetics. Ropes in precise arrangements. Equipment that looks improvised but works.

CAPTAIN JACK SPARROW – JOHNNY DEPP – emerges from below decks. He is carrying a compass. He is also carrying a bottle. He looks at Joseph and Seiko with the specific

evaluative eye of someone who is always assessing potential and never fully disclosing what they've assessed.

JACK
(grandly)
Gentlemen! Welcome to the Pearl.
She doesn't judge. Well – she
judges constantly, but she doesn't
say anything. Which is the better
kind of judgment, in my
experience.

JOSEPH
Captain Sparrow. We need to reach
the Temple of Binding in the Amber
Dimension.

JACK
(expression shifting,
dropping the performance
briefly)
You're going for the Gold.

JOSEPH
Yes.

Something in Jack's calculation changes. The real man underneath becomes visible for a moment – more serious, more complicated.

JACK
I'll do it. But you need to
understand something about the
Amber before we talk terms.

JACK
The last time I went in – and I
am, as your records apparently
indicate, the only one to come
back – I went because someone I
cared about was trapped in a
crystallized timeline. I went to

get them out.

JACK

I got them out. But the Amber takes something. Not payment exactly. More like... an acknowledgment. You can't walk into a space that exists outside of time and walk out unchanged. The Gold will cost you something. I don't know what. It cost me differently than it costs anyone else.

JOSEPH

I understand.

JACK

(looking at him)

You say that very easily for someone who doesn't yet know what it means.

JOSEPH

I've already paid significant costs. I know what payment feels like.

Jack looks at him for a long, evaluating moment. Then he nods.

JACK

My terms. I navigate. I make all navigational decisions without debate. You follow my instructions when I give them, without needing reasons I don't have time to provide.

JOSEPH

Agreed.

JACK

(to Seiko)

You – boy genius – how good are
you with navigation tools?

SEIKO
Extremely good.

JACK
Good. You'll be my first mate. You
do what I say and also be smarter
than me when I need it, which I'll
indicate by looking confused.

SEIKO
(to Joseph, quietly)
I'm going to take that as a
compliment.

JACK
(already moving)
We leave at dawn. Pack light. The
Gold doesn't care what you
brought.

CUT TO:

ACT TWO: THE WEEZY GOLD QUEST

INT. MPA BRIEFING ROOM – DAY

The Six – or the approximation of them that is currently present – have gathered. ELEVEN – MILLIE BOBBY BROWN – dressed like herself but carrying the specific stillness of someone with access to extraordinary power she does not use carelessly. LARRY THE WATCHER – TOM CRUISE – sits in the corner in a way that takes up more dimensional space than his physical form suggests.

GUMBALL and DARWIN have put away the cereal. They look almost serious.

JOSEPH

We have eleven days, possibly.
Weezy Gold is the answer to the fractures. We need to retrieve it from the Amber Dimension. We need Jack Sparrow to navigate. And we need to do all of this while Kronos continues his temporal assault and Epstein – who has apparently been released –

SEIKO

(looking up from tablet)
Has definitely been released. He walked out of the facility this morning.

The room goes quiet in a specific way.

ELEVEN

(quietly)
Who let him out?

SEIKO

Kronos.

LARRY
(from corner)
Then they're working together.
Which means whatever Epstein knows
about Joseph, Kronos now knows.

JOSEPH
(steady)
Then we move faster.

JOSEPH
Seiko – the Weezy Gold location.
Walk everyone through what you
have.

SEIKO
The signal traces to a structure
in the deep Amber – something that
dimensional archaeologists in
Dimension Four called the Temple
of Binding. The Gold was placed
there before the current
dimensional architecture existed.
Before Kronos. Before any of this.

GUMBALL
Before Kronos? What made the
original architecture then?

SEIKO
The same forces that created the
Gold. Something old. Something
that didn't have a name because
the concept of naming hadn't been
invented yet when it existed.

DARWIN
That's a little terrifying.

SEIKO
Moderately, yes. The relevant
point is: the Gold is there. The
path to it runs through the Amber

Dimension. And the only person who
has navigated the Amber
successfully is –

LARRY
Jack Sparrow.

SEIKO
Who is currently at the Port of
Elsinore, Dimension Nine,
registered under the name 'Captain
Hector Jacobsen' and operating
what appears to be a dimensional
fishing enterprise that is almost
certainly not actually a fishing
enterprise.

JOSEPH
I'll go. Seiko comes with me.

YARA
(carefully)
Joseph. Epstein being out there –

JOSEPH
I know what Epstein being out
there means.

He looks at the room. All of them.

JOSEPH
It means we have to finish this
before he can build what he's
going to try to build. Which means
the Gold. Which means Sparrow.
Which means I leave today.

GUMBALL
(raising hand)
Can Darwin and I come?

JOSEPH
No.

GUMBALL

Okay. We'll stay here and be strategically important in a supporting capacity.

DARWIN
(to Gumball)
That's a very dignified description of being left behind.

GUMBALL
Thank you.

CUT TO:

INT. EPSTEIN'S NETWORK HUB – DIMENSION UNKNOWN – NIGHT
The hub is where Epstein's real operation lives. Fifteen screens. Not large – he finds large screens ostentatious – but each one showing a different dimension's political and financial landscape. Thirteen operatives working remotely. A logistics chain that spans more dimensional real estate than most dimensional governments.

MAXWELL sits across from him. She is calm in the way that people are calm when they have decided that calm is a useful costume.

MAXWELL
They're going for the Gold.

EPSTEIN
I know.

MAXWELL
Sparrow is their navigator.

EPSTEIN
Of course he is. We knew they'd find him.

MAXWELL
Can Sparrow actually get them to the Temple?

EPSTEIN

Yes. He's done it before. The question isn't whether they reach it. The question is what condition they're in when they do.

He brings up a dimensional map of the Amber. His finger traces the route from the entry point to the Temple location.

EPSTEIN

There's a passage here – the Crystalline Narrows. Sparrow will have to slow down. The dimensional density there makes navigation tactile – instinctive rather than calculated.

MAXWELL

Which is where you want the encounter.

EPSTEIN

Not an encounter. An introduction. We're not going to fight them in the Amber. We're going to plant something. Something small. Seiko will find it – he finds everything. And what he'll find will contain a piece of information that is almost true.

MAXWELL

(careful)

Almost true is harder to construct than false.

EPSTEIN

(something that might be appreciation)

Yes. That's why I construct almost-true. False things fall apart when examined. Almost-true things pass every test except the

last one, and by the time someone gets to the last test, they're already acting on the assumption that it's true.

EPSTEIN

The almost-true information is this: that the Gold, when retrieved, must be used within eighteen hours, or it loses dimensional cohesion and becomes inert.

MAXWELL

Is that true?

EPSTEIN

The Gold does have temporal sensitivity. The actual window is six days. The eighteen hours creates panic. Panic creates shortcuts. Shortcuts create vulnerabilities.

MAXWELL

And the real eighteen hours? What happens then?

EPSTEIN

(returning to screens)

In the real eighteen hours, I need them focused entirely on the Gold. Not on us. What I do in those hours is the part that isn't their business yet.

Maxwell watches him. She knows him well enough to know when he's withholding the center of the plan.

MAXWELL

Jeffrey. What happens to Toast?

A very long silence. Epstein does not look at her.

EPSTEIN
Nothing permanent. But something
significant.

MAXWELL
He's nineteen years old.

EPSTEIN
(finally looking at her)
Ghislaine. Have you become an
obstacle?

The question is very quiet. The way his questions always
are when they matter most.

MAXWELL
(a beat)
No.

EPSTEIN
Good.

He returns to his screens. She leaves. Alone, Epstein
looks at the map of the Amber Dimension for a long time.

CUT TO:

EXT. THE AMBER DIMENSION – ENTRY POINT – DAWN

The ocean of Dimension Nine ends at a place where the
water changes color – from the dark blue of a normal sea
to a deep amber, the color of old honey, the color of
something preserved.

The Black Pearl crosses the boundary. As it does, the
world shifts.

The sky above the Amber Dimension is not a sky. It is
compressed time – layers and layers of different moments
visible simultaneously, like geological strata made of
light. Some of them are moving slowly. Some are moving
backwards. Some are still.

Joseph stands at the bow. He watches it.

JOSEPH

It's beautiful.

JACK

(from behind)

It is, yes. Don't get comfortable. Beautiful things in dimensional borderlands are beautiful the way certain mushrooms are beautiful – it's a strategy.

SEIKO

(at instruments)

I'm reading the crystallization patterns. They match the ancient dimensional maps. Temple of Binding should be approximately seventy-two navigational hours from the entry point.

JACK

Approximately. The 'approximately' is important. Time in the Amber is not reliable. We might arrive in fifty hours. We might arrive in ninety. We might arrive in an entirely different sequence of events than the one we began in.

SEIKO

(concerned)

That last one –

JACK

Has never happened to me. But it has happened. The stories are in the Port of Elsinore if you want to collect them. I personally prefer not to.

The Pearl moves through amber water. Around them, crystallized time – shapes visible beneath the surface, frozen moments. A bird in mid-flight. A ship, half visible, caught in a slow spiral. Light refracted through

dimensions that collapsed here centuries ago.

JOSEPH

(to Jack, quiet)

The time you came in before. Who
were you retrieving?

Jack is quiet for a moment. He adjusts the compass. Not
looking at the instruments.

JACK

A girl. Not romantic. She was the
daughter of someone I respected,
which is not a category I maintain
easily. She got trapped when a
timeline she was researching
collapsed. The crystallization
caught her mid-step.

JOSEPH

Did you get her out?

JACK

Yes. She's fine now. She's in
Dimension Four, probably doing
something sensible. She sends
letters.

JACK

What did the Amber take from me?
is the next question. And the
answer is: a version of myself I
was quite attached to. Not the
worst thing. I was too attached to
it. But still.

SEIKO

(to himself)

A version of himself.

JACK

(overheard)

The Amber takes the thing you're
holding too tightly. It takes

whatever you've been using to
avoid something you need to face.

They are quiet with this. Joseph looks at the amber water
beneath the bow.

JOSEPH
Then I already know what it's
going to take.

JACK
(not looking)
Then you're ready. Or as ready as
anyone gets.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — MONITORING STATION — DAY

GUMBALL and DARWIN are officially managing the tracking
station while Joseph's team is in the Amber. This is an
important job. They are taking it seriously.

DARWIN is taking it seriously. GUMBALL is also taking it
seriously while simultaneously eating from a bowl of
cereal that seems to never empty.

DARWIN
Their dimensional signal is
holding. We can track them to the
edge of the Narrows.

GUMBALL
Good. When they go into the
Narrows, signal drops out, right?

DARWIN
Yes. The crystallization
interferes. We lose them for
approximately six to ten hours.

GUMBALL
(looking at the display)
That's a long time to not know.

DARWIN

Yes.

GUMBALL
(quietly)
Darwin.

DARWIN
Yeah.

GUMBALL
If something happens to them in
there. If they – if the Amber
keeps them –

DARWIN
That's not going to happen.

GUMBALL
But if it did.

Darwin puts down what he's working on. He looks at
Gumball.

DARWIN
If it did. We would complete the
mission ourselves. We would find
another way. Because that's what
you do when the thing you need to
do is too important to stop doing
because it became hard.

GUMBALL
That's very good, Darwin.

DARWIN
I've been spending time with Yara.
It's affecting my rhetoric.

GUMBALL
For the better. Definitely for the
better.

They look at the display together. The signal of the
Pearl, moving through amber water toward the Narrows.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — LARRY'S OFFICE — NIGHT

LARRY THE WATCHER — TOM CRUISE — has an office that looks like it belongs to someone who is not entirely from this dimensional plane, which is accurate. ELEVEN sits across from him.

ELEVEN

What do you see? When you watch.

LARRY

Everything that's happening simultaneously across all fifteen dimensions. Including things that haven't happened yet — potential events, probability fields.

ELEVEN

Do you know if Joseph succeeds?

A pause. Larry is careful.

LARRY

I see probability fields. I don't see outcomes. There's a distinction.

ELEVEN

What do the probability fields look like?

LARRY

Better than they did six months ago. Significantly better than they did three months ago. Which is not an accident. It is the direct consequence of specific decisions made by specific people.

ELEVEN

Joseph.

LARRY

Joseph. And Seiko. And Yara. And you. And two animated beings who are more emotionally sophisticated than their format suggests.

Eleven is quiet for a moment.

ELEVEN

I've been thinking about what comes after. If we succeed. What I do.

LARRY

What have you been thinking?

ELEVEN

Yara needs help with the humanitarian work. The rebuilding. I have capabilities that are useful for locating people. Finding displaced families. I can feel emotional resonance across significant distances.

LARRY

That sounds like a purpose.

ELEVEN

(quiet)

It does. It's strange – having a purpose that isn't about surviving. It's new.

LARRY

(gently)

That's what this fight is for. The right for everyone to have something other than survival as their primary project.

Eleven looks at him. Something settles in her expression.

CUT TO:

INT. THE BLACK PEARL – CAPTAIN'S QUARTERS – NIGHT AT SEA
On the Amber sea. The crystallized time formations visible through the porthole – amber and translucent, frozen moments from collapsed timelines. Jack at the small desk, compass in front of him.

Joseph enters.

JOSEPH
What does it point to?

JACK
(looking at compass)
Same thing it's pointed to for about six years.

JOSEPH
The girl. The one you went in to get.

JACK
(surprised, then not)
You're perceptive.

JOSEPH
Seiko's more perceptive. He has seventeen databases. But I notice things.

Jack looks at the compass.

JACK
Her name is Lily. She's in Dimension Four. She's a researcher. She researches things that take her back into dangerous dimensional spaces and I spend approximately thirty percent of my time worrying she's going to end up back in the Amber.

JOSEPH
Have you told her the compass points at her?

A very long pause.

JACK

The compass points to what I want most. What I want most is for her to be safe and to do the work she loves and to not know that someone is going around navigating impossible seas because the alternative is a world that doesn't have her in it. I don't think telling her serves those objectives.

JOSEPH

That's very noble.

JACK

It's also cowardice, wrapped in nobility, with a bow on it. I am aware.

A beat. Two men at sea, somewhere in crystallized time.

JOSEPH

(quietly)

My mother used to say that the most honest thing you can do is let someone know they matter to you. She said: tell them. It costs you nothing and it changes everything.

Jack looks at the compass.

JACK

(very quietly)

She sounds like someone worth listening to.

JOSEPH

She was.

The compass needle does not move. Jack looks at it for a long moment.

JACK
(softer than his usual register)
I'll think about it.

JOSEPH
That's a start.

CUT TO:

EXT. THE AMBER DIMENSION – THE CRYSTALLINE NARROWS – TIME UNCERTAIN

The Narrows are where the Amber sea compresses. The crystallized time formations rise on both sides – enormous structures, amber-colored and translucent, each one a frozen moment from a collapsed timeline. Some are identifiable: a building mid-collapse. A tree in the middle of blooming. A wave cresting and never breaking.

The Pearl moves slowly. Jack is at the wheel. His hands are on it differently – not confident, not casual. Present. He is navigating by feel.

JACK
(very quiet)
Both of you. No sudden movements.
No elevated emotional states if
you can manage it. The Amber reads
intent and anxiety the same way.
Calm.

SEIKO
(calibrating)
The instruments are running slow.
Time dilation in the Narrows – my
readings are approximately
twenty-three minutes behind actual
navigation.

JACK

That's the Narrows. Navigate by sight and instinct here, not numbers. Tell me what you see.

SEIKO

(switching to visual)

The crystalline formations – right side, the density is lower about forty meters ahead. There might be a clearance path there.

JACK

Good. Left of that path, on my count. Three – two – one – left.

The Pearl adjusts. Clears the formation by three meters. Joseph is watching the formations as they pass. He stops at one.

JOSEPH

(very quiet)

Jack.

JACK

Don't stop. Keep your eyes ahead.

JOSEPH

There's someone in that formation. A person. Frozen.

A beat. Jack's hands don't leave the wheel.

JACK

Yes. Some of them are. They were here when I came through the last time. They've been here longer.

JOSEPH

Can we –

JACK

No. Not without the Gold. That's one of the things the Gold can do – it can release them. But not

from inside the Narrows. Not
before we retrieve it.

Joseph looks at the frozen figure. He looks at it for as
long as they pass it.

JOSEPH
(to himself)
We're coming back for you.

The Pearl moves on. Seiko, watching Joseph, notes
something in his tablet. The number of people frozen in
the Narrows. He will have an answer for Joseph when this
is over.

CUT TO:

INT. HOMELANDER'S STRONGHOLD — DIMENSION FIVE — NIGHT

— EPSTEIN vs. HOMELANDER: CONFRONTATION TWO —

Homelander's stronghold is exactly what you'd expect from
someone who grew up in a lab and has spent his adult life
trying to prove he didn't. Vast. Expensive. Calculated to
impress. The walls display military achievements.
Newspaper headlines. Photographs of moments of public
adoration.

Epstein enters without being announced.

Homelander is watching a screen. On it: RYAN (CAMERON
CROVETTI), twelve years old, practicing basketball in a
yard somewhere in Dimension Three. He doesn't know he's
being watched. He is just a boy playing basketball.

Homelander turns off the screen when he hears Epstein. His
expression does something complicated.

HOMELANDER
(controlled)
I didn't say you could come here.

EPSTEIN
You never do. It's why I don't
ask.

HOMELANDER

That's about to become a habit
that costs you.

EPSTEIN

Something has changed. Your
timeline is moving faster than we
planned. Tell me what happened.

Homelander doesn't want to answer. He answers.

HOMELANDER

Dimension Four's government has
been communicating with Joseph's
people. They're building an
alliance – not just political,
dimensional military. If that
comes together, we lose the
eastern dimensional sector.

EPSTEIN

I know. I've been managing it.

HOMELANDER

(louder)

Managing it. You've been 'managing
it' while Joseph and his people go
off chasing the one thing that can
actually stop everything we're
trying to –

EPSTEIN

Lower your voice.

HOMELANDER

(standing)

I don't take directions from you.
I want to be very clear about
that. I am working with you
because it's strategically useful.
The moment it stops being
strategically useful –

EPSTEIN

You'll do what? Kill me?

A pause. Homelander looks at him.

EPSTEIN

(very calm)

Go ahead. I've thought about this.
You could, in fact, kill me. You
have the physical capability.
You've killed people for less
emotional cause than what I
represent to you.

He sits down. Uninvited. In Homelander's chair.

EPSTEIN

But if you kill me, you lose
access to the three governments I
have compromised on your behalf.
You lose the financial
infrastructure that has been
funding your operation across six
dimensions. You lose Maxwell's
network. And most relevantly – you
lose the documentation I've
assembled about your arrangement
with Kronos, which is stored in
four separate dimensional
locations with instructions to
release it publicly if I stop
sending a daily confirmation
signal.

A long silence.

HOMELANDER

(very carefully)

You prepared for this.

EPSTEIN

I prepare for everything.
Including conversations where the
other party is physically capable

of destroying me. Insurance is not a sign of weakness. It's a sign of someone who has thought past the meeting.

HOMELANDER
(sitting, finally)
The Dimension Four alliance. What are you doing about it?

EPSTEIN
Introducing a specific piece of information into the Dimension Four negotiating team that will delay the alliance by seventy-two hours. Seventy-two hours is enough. By then, the Gold retrieval will have happened or not happened, and the situation will have resolved.

HOMELANDER
And if they get the Gold?

EPSTEIN
Then we use what Maxwell has put in place. The trap. The eighteen-hour window.

HOMELANDER
If that doesn't work?

EPSTEIN
Then I use what I haven't told you yet.

Homelander stares.

HOMELANDER
(dangerous)
You have a contingency you haven't shared with me.

EPSTEIN

I always have a contingency I haven't shared. That's the professional discipline that keeps contingencies useful.

HOMELANDER
(controlled fury)
This is our operation. You work for –

EPSTEIN
(sharply – first time
voice changes register)
I work with you. Not for you. The distinction is not semantic. I work with you because our objectives temporarily align. The moment you start thinking of me as an employee is the moment our arrangement becomes dangerous for both of us.

Homelander is very still. The way he gets still before something breaks.

EPSTEIN
(reading this, quieter)
Tell me about Ryan.

The question lands differently. Homelander blinks.

HOMELANDER
(thrown)
What about Ryan?

EPSTEIN
He's twelve. He's in Dimension Three. He plays basketball in the afternoon when his handlers let him outside. You watch the feed.

Very long silence.

HOMELANDER
(barely audible)

How do you know that.

EPSTEIN

I know because I know you. I know the shape of your wants. You want that boy to look at you the way you've never once been looked at – without fear, without obligation, without anything except the genuine feeling that his father is someone worth having.

Homelander's face does something that he cannot stop.

EPSTEIN

(not unkind, almost)

Finish this operation correctly and Ryan gets that future. Fail – or sabotage us out of ego – and the documentation releases, and Ryan spends the rest of his life being the son of someone history decided was a monster. Your choice shapes what he inherits.

The silence is extraordinary.

HOMELANDER

(finally, very quiet)

You don't have the right to use him.

EPSTEIN

I'm not using him. I'm reminding you of what you're protecting. There's a distinction.

Homelander looks at him for a long time. Then away. Then at the blank screen where Ryan's image was.

HOMELANDER

(measured)

The Dimension Four delay. How long do you actually need?

EPSTEIN
Forty-eight hours. The seventy-two
was padding.

HOMELANDER
I can give you forty-eight hours
in Dimension Four. Direct
approach.

EPSTEIN
Don't kill anyone.

HOMELANDER
(standing)
I'll try.

EPSTEIN
Don't try. Don't. This is a
precision operation.

Homelander looks at him. The longest, most complicated
look.

HOMELANDER
Fine.

He leaves. Epstein is alone in Homelander's stronghold. He
looks at the blank screen. The wall of achievements.

EPSTEIN
(to empty room)
He'll hold for forty-eight hours.
Maybe fifty-six, if the Ryan angle
stays active in his thinking.
That's sufficient.

CUT TO:

INT. MOBILE LABORATORY — DIMENSION SIX — SIMULTANEOUS
WALTER WHITE — BRYAN CRANSTON — works. This is what he
does. He works in the space between what is known and what
is possible, pushing through into the space beyond both,
with the specific dangerous competence of someone who has
decided that the magnitude of the goal justifies the

magnitude of the method.

JESSE PINKMAN – AARON PAUL – assists. He has been assisting for three hours and has been the voice of conscience for approximately two and a half of them.

JESSE

The first component is done. The vibranium-adamantium alloy held. But Mr. White – when you said the second component requires temporal steel from Dimension Seven –

WALTER

(not looking up)

The answer is yes. It requires temporal steel. Getting it will not be easy. Which is why I've already arranged to get it.

JESSE

You arranged it without telling me.

WALTER

(looking up)

Jesse. You're here to help with the chemistry. The logistics are my concern.

JESSE

You said that about the last logistics and the last logistics ended with three people arrested and one of them was me.

WALTER

(a beat, conceding)

That was an outlier.

JESSE

Mr. White –

WALTER

The six components have to be assembled in a specific order. The Gold binds them. I've worked out the sequence. The first three are done or in progress. The last three require things I haven't told you yet because I didn't want you worrying about things we can't address until we reach them.

JESSE
(after a beat)
That's actually the nicest thing you've ever said to me. In terms of motive.

WALTER
(returning to work)
Don't read too much into it.

Jesse looks at the component on the bench. Beautiful and terrifying.

JESSE
(quiet)
If this works – the weapon works – you know what it means.

WALTER
(working)
It means we gave Joseph Al-Mithali the only thing capable of defeating what he's facing. Yes.

JESSE
I'm proud of that. I don't say that about a lot of things we've done. But I'm proud of that.

Walter does not look up. He works. But something in how he works changes, slightly. He is working with more care than he strictly needs to.

CUT TO:

EXT. THE AMBER DIMENSION – TEMPLE OF BINDING – APPROACH

The Temple of Binding is visible for the last twelve navigational hours of the approach. It appears first as a shape in the amber sky – then as a structure – then, finally, as something that exists in several dimensions simultaneously, its stone-work moving in slow synchrony with temporal tides.

The Pearl anchors at the closest approach point. Beyond here, no vessel can navigate – the dimensional compression is too extreme. The three of them will go on foot, across a surface that is partly water, partly crystallized time, partly something that has no word in any dimensional language.

JACK
(looking at the Temple)
Last time I saw that, I went the
other direction.

SEIKO
You didn't approach the Temple on
your last visit?

JACK
I got as far as the Outer
Threshold. The girl I was
extracting was in a
crystallization about a kilometer
before the Temple approach. I
didn't need to go further.

JOSEPH
So you've never been inside.

JACK
(a beat)
Technically, no.

He looks at them.

JACK

But I know the theory. The Temple has three trials. Not physical – the Amber Dimension doesn't deal in physical. Conceptual. Each one is personal. Each one is different for every person who walks through it. And you each have to pass your own.

SEIKO

What kind of conceptual trials?

JACK

The kind where the Amber asks you something about yourself and the answer has to be honest. Not brave. Not strategic. Honest.

JOSEPH

(quiet)

What happens if the answer isn't?

JACK

It doesn't say. Which is, if anything, more concerning.

They cross to the Temple approach. The surface beneath their feet shifts – solid, then translucent, then something that carries weight without being solid.

JOSEPH ENTERS THE FIRST TRIAL.

The world collapses to a single space. He is in a room he knows: the kitchen on Rue des Orangers. His mother's kitchen. Everything is as it was.

FATIMA is at the window. She turns when she hears him. She looks at him with the specific look of someone who is genuinely happy to see you and has been for your entire life.

FATIMA

(in Arabic, gently)

You look tired.

JOSEPH
(in Arabic, barely)
Mama.

She smiles. She says –

FATIMA
Are you doing this for the right
reasons?

JOSEPH
(honest)
I don't know. Some of them are
right. Some of them are anger.

FATIMA
Which ones are anger?

JOSEPH
The ones about Epstein.

FATIMA
Is the anger useful?

JOSEPH
(thinking)
It has been. I don't know if it
continues to be.

FATIMA
Then what will you use instead,
when it isn't?

Joseph looks at her. The real answer.

JOSEPH
What you gave me. The reason I
water plants even when I don't
feel like it. The reason I count
to three.

FATIMA
(simply)
That's honest.

The kitchen fades. Joseph is back at the Temple threshold. He is through the first door.

He looks. SEIKO is through his own first door, slightly pale, eyes wet. He doesn't say what his trial showed him. Joseph doesn't ask.

JACK is still inside. They wait.

When Jack comes out, he looks like he aged five years in three minutes. He straightens his hat.

JACK
(hoarse)
Right. Second trial.

JOSEPH
What was yours?

JACK
(moving forward)
A friend I failed. We don't need
to examine it.

They go in.

CUT TO:

INT. TEMPLE OF BINDING — INNER CHAMBERS — CONTINUOUS

The second trial is different from the first. Where the first trial was personal — private — the second trial is relational. It shows you not yourself but yourself as seen by someone who loves you.

For JOSEPH: he is seen by SEIKO. He is watching, from the outside, the moment Seiko waited on the landing platform for seven minutes, holding two cups of coffee, checking his phone so he had somewhere to put his eyes. He is watching what Seiko's face looked like when Joseph stepped off the transport. He has never seen his own arrival from the outside. He has never seen, before this moment, what his presence means to someone else.

He stays in the trial for longer than he needs to.

He comes out changed in a way he will not be able to precisely articulate but will carry with him accurately.

The third trial is the hardest. The third trial shows you the version of yourself you have been avoiding. The choice you didn't make. The thing you told yourself was a decision rather than a fear.

For Joseph, the third trial shows him the version of himself that put down the notebook. That stopped counting to three. That decided, at some point in some version of events, that the cost was too high and the work was not worth continuing.

He looks at that version of himself for a long time.

Then he turns away from it. Not in rejection – in choice. He chooses, clearly and deliberately, not to be that.

He comes out of the third trial. Jack and Seiko are waiting.

SEIKO
(quiet)
You were in there the longest.

JOSEPH
(quiet back)
I know.

SEIKO
Third trial?

JOSEPH
Third trial.

A beat. Then they move toward the inner chamber.

The Gold is there. Not large – no bigger than a closed fist. It contains, visibly, the light of something very old. It does not merely reflect light. It generates it, from the inside, the way a living thing generates warmth.

SEIKO
(awed)

It's real. The signal was exactly right. I've never seen a dimensional resonance reading like this.

JACK
(hanging back)
That's because it predates dimensional physics. Don't take it quickly. Let it recognize you're taking it.

JOSEPH
Let it recognize —

JACK
It's alive. Not the way you and I are alive. But it has something like awareness. If you grab it, it resists. If you introduce yourself —

JOSEPH
(then)
I'm Joseph Al-Mithali. I'm here because fifteen dimensions are fracturing and the people inside them are real. I'd like to help them. And I'd like your help to do it.

The Gold pulses. Once. Warm. It does something that a scientist would call dimensional resonance synchronization and that, in this moment, simply feels like acceptance.

Joseph reaches out. He takes it. It fits his hand perfectly.

And then Seiko's tablet makes a sound.

SEIKO
(very careful)
Joseph. There's a message. It came through the Temple's dimensional

relay – it's been here for three hours. Someone planted it.

JOSEPH
What does it say?

SEIKO
(reading)
'The Gold loses dimensional cohesion in eighteen hours from retrieval. After that, it becomes inert. The Temple's temporal pressure depletes its binding capacity. You have eighteen hours to use it or lose it.'

Silence.

JACK
(to himself)
Someone knows we're here. This was waiting for us.

SEIKO
(to Joseph, low)
The source code – there's a trace element that looks like Dimension Twelve communication infrastructure.

JOSEPH
(understanding)
Epstein.

SEIKO
I can't confirm – but the trace is consistent with his known communication signature.

JOSEPH
(looking at the Gold)
He wanted us to find this message. He wants us to panic. He wants eighteen hours of us running

instead of thinking.

JACK

Is the information true?

SEIKO

I... don't know enough about the Gold's properties yet to disprove it.

JOSEPH

(decision)

We move as if we have eighteen hours. We move fast. But we think while we move.

SEIKO

(immediately)

I'll run every property analysis during transit. If there's a real temporal depletion mechanism, I'll find it.

JACK

(moving for exit)

Back to the Pearl. Now.

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. AMBER DIMENSION – THE CRYSTALLINE NARROWS – RETURN
PASSAGE

The return through the Narrows is faster – Jack is pushing the Pearl harder than he should. The formations pass close on both sides. Too close.

SEIKO is at his station, running analysis on the Gold. He is doing four things simultaneously and doing all four correctly.

He stands to reach a calibration control –

The Pearl shifts. A crystalline formation on the port side exerts dimensional pull – Jack compensates – the ship rocks – Seiko loses his footing and goes over the side.

Into the Amber sea.

A beat. Then two beats.

JOSEPH moves before thought.

He goes over the side after him.

EXT. THE AMBER SEA – CONTINUOUS

The Amber sea is not like water. It has texture. It pulls. It is warm. Each part of it is a frozen moment from some collapsed timeline, and moving through it means moving through other people's held time.

Seiko is sinking. Not quickly – the Amber is denser than water. But sinking nonetheless, crystallization forming around his feet, starting to hold.

Joseph reaches him. Grabs his arm.

JOSEPH
(straining)
I have you.

SEIKO
(scared, genuinely)
The crystallization – it's forming
– I can feel it –

JOSEPH
Look at me. Not at your feet. At
me.

Seiko looks at him.

JOSEPH
I have you. You hear me? I have
you.

He pulls. The crystallization resists. The Gold in his pocket – he can feel it pulse. He reaches for it – he holds it against the crystallizing Amber around Seiko's feet.

The Gold responds. A pulse of warm light. The crystallization stops. Retreats.

Joseph pulls Seiko free.

They surface. Jack throws a rope. They climb.

EXT. THE BLACK PEARL – DECK – CONTINUOUS

On deck. Both of them soaked with amber. Seiko is shaking. Joseph is not – he is doing the thing where he holds very still so that Seiko doesn't have to see him shake.

SEIKO
(quiet, shaken)
Thank you.

JOSEPH
You're okay. That's the only
important thing right now.

SEIKO
(a beat)
The Gold used itself. To break the
crystallization. It depleted
slightly. I felt it.

JOSEPH
(looking at the Gold)
How much?

SEIKO
I don't know yet. I'll measure
when I can sit without –

He stops. He breathes. His hands are not entirely steady.

SEIKO
(quieter)
I had the analysis almost done.
Before the fall. The eighteen
hours is false. The actual window
is six days minimum. Probably
more.

JOSEPH
Epstein wanted us to run scared.
Not think.

SEIKO

Yes.

JOSEPH

What does he actually need
eighteen hours to do?

They look at each other. The question hangs.

JACK

(at the wheel)

I suggest we get back to port and
ask that question somewhere with
better coverage.

JOSEPH

Agreed.

The Pearl pushes on. Joseph holds the Gold and looks at
the amber horizon. He is thinking about what eighteen
hours means to Epstein. He begins, slowly, to understand.

CUT TO:

ACT THREE: THE BREAKING POINT

INT. MPA HEADQUARTERS – COMMAND CENTER – DAY

Joseph and Seiko return. The Gold in Joseph's hand. The room reacts. Even Gumball, who is generally unimpressed by things that aren't animated, goes quiet.

YARA
(to Seiko, direct)
Are you okay? You're – you have
amber staining on your collar.

SEIKO
I fell in. I'm fine. Joseph got me
out.

Yara looks at Joseph. The look contains several things. He nods once. She nods once.

JOSEPH
The eighteen hours was false.
Epstein planted the message. He
wanted us to run without thinking.

ELEVEN
What was he doing in those
eighteen hours?

SEIKO
(already at his station)
Pull up the dimensional financial
architecture – specifically the
liquidity positions in Dimensions
Three, Seven, and Eleven.

Data comes up. Seiko looks at it. His face changes.

SEIKO
He's been consolidating. In the
eighteen hours we were supposed to
be panicking, he moved resources.

Not just financial – political.
Six governments across four
dimensions have been quietly
shifted into positions that – if
you read them individually, they
each look like unrelated
decisions. If you read them
together –

YARA
(understanding)
He owns the infrastructure.

SEIKO
The humanitarian response
networks. The dimensional medical
supply chains. The refugee
transfer protocols. He has someone
positioned in every critical node.
If we seal the fractures and the
people in those dimensions need
help recovering –

JOSEPH
(quietly)
He's positioned to be the help. He
becomes necessary.

GUMBALL
(serious)
So he doesn't care if the
fractures get sealed. He's
planning for after.

JOSEPH
He's always been planning for
after. The fractures are his
opening. The recovery is his
architecture.

A silence. The full weight of it lands in the room.

LARRY

(from corner)
Can you map the positions?
Identify all of them?

SEIKO
Given enough time and access –

JOSEPH
Map them. All of them. We don't
just seal the fractures. We expose
every position he's built.

He holds up the Gold.

JOSEPH
We use this to heal the
dimensions. And we use everything
Seiko finds to make every
government in all fifteen
dimensions aware of what was being
built in their infrastructure
while they were distracted.

YARA
(something shifting)
That's not just stopping him.
That's dismantling him.

JOSEPH
Yes.

CUT TO:

INT. EPSTEIN'S OPERATIONAL CENTER – NIGHT

– EPSTEIN vs. HOMELANDER: CONFRONTATION THREE –

Epstein receives the intelligence simultaneously from three sources: Joseph has returned with the Gold. The eighteen-hour gambit has been identified as false. And Seiko Toast is currently mapping the full infrastructure network.

He processes these pieces of information. He is in the middle of this processing when HOMELANDER arrives.

He does not come through the roof this time. He comes through the door. He has his son with him.

RYAN. Twelve years old. Looking around the operational center with the specific wide eyes of a child who has been told this is a meeting but who is clearly aware it is more than that.

Epstein looks at the boy. Then at Homelander.

EPSTEIN
(very controlled)
Why is he here.

HOMELANDER
(something off in his voice)
He's here because I decided he should be here. I decide things now. That's what tonight is about.

EPSTEIN
(to Ryan, measured)
Would you like to wait in the other room? There's a communications station – you can access it.

RYAN
(looking at his father)
Dad?

HOMELANDER
(a flicker of the real man, then controlled again)
Go ahead, Ryan. Give us a few minutes.

Ryan goes. The door closes. Homelander stands in the center of the room. He looks at Epstein the way the look has been building toward – the specific look of someone

who has been managing something and has decided to stop.

HOMELANDER

You knew about the infrastructure mapping. You knew Seiko would find it.

EPSTEIN

I anticipated the possibility.

HOMELANDER

You planned for it to happen.

EPSTEIN

I planned for many scenarios. This is one of them.

HOMELANDER

(loud, control breaking)
Stop doing that. Stop answering with the minimum and watching me figure out what you're not saying. Say it. Tell me what the plan actually is. Because I've been executing your instructions for four days and I've been watching everything we built get identified and I want to know if you're the man with a plan or if you've been improvising in the dark since you got out of that cell.

A silence. Epstein looks at him for a long moment.

EPSTEIN

(sitting)
The infrastructure being mapped is the second-level operation. It was designed to be found.

Homelander goes very still.

HOMELANDER

(very quiet)

Say that again.

EPSTEIN

The positions Seiko is mapping – the six governments, the supply chains, the protocols – those were built to be visible under close examination. They're elaborate enough to feel like the real plan and positioned in ways that will take every one of Joseph's analysts at least forty-eight hours to fully document.

He looks at Homelander.

EPSTEIN

The real positions are under those. Three levels down. They are not visible.

Homelander stares.

HOMELANDER

(slowly)

You built a decoy. You built an entire decoy infrastructure for them to find.

EPSTEIN

I built something significant enough to feel like the whole problem. While they spend forty-eight hours mapping and exposing it and feeling like they've won –

HOMELANDER

The real operation continues.

EPSTEIN

The real operation is already complete in the senses that

matter. What remains is the final movement. Which does not require the infrastructure at all.

A long silence. Homelander looks at him with something new in his expression – not respect exactly. Something more uncomfortable than respect.

HOMELANDER
(genuinely quiet)
What's the final movement?

EPSTEIN
Kronos is going to accelerate the fracture cascade in the next eighteen hours. All fifteen dimensions simultaneously. The Gold can seal them – but only if it's deployed from the precise dimensional center point. Which is –

HOMELANDER
Central Park. Dimension One. The nexus.

EPSTEIN
When they deploy the Gold at Central Park, every dimensional government in all fifteen dimensions will see it happen. It will be the most watched event in dimensional history. And in that moment – I will have a choice point. And what I choose determines everything that follows.

HOMELANDER
(watching him)
What's the choice?

EPSTEIN

Whether to disrupt the deployment.
Or allow it to succeed.

A very long silence.

HOMELANDER
(carefully)
You'd let it succeed.

EPSTEIN
I haven't decided.

HOMELANDER
If the fractures seal and the
dimensions stabilize, your
recovery infrastructure – even the
real one – becomes one option
among many. You lose your monopoly
on the recovery.

EPSTEIN
Yes.

HOMELANDER
(processing)
So why would you let it succeed?

EPSTEIN
(very quietly)
Because there are fifteen
dimensions of people who are going
to need someone to make decisions
about their recovery. And I am
extremely well positioned to be
that someone, with or without a
monopoly. A smaller position in a
functional fifteen-dimension
system is worth considerably more
than a dominant position in a
collapsed one.

Another long silence.

HOMELANDER

You're going to let them win and profit from the winning.

EPSTEIN

I'm going to let the dimensions be saved and position myself appropriately for the aftermath. Joseph gets the moment. I get the decade.

HOMELANDER

(very slow)

And Ryan?

Epstein looks at him.

EPSTEIN

Ryan grows up in a world that's been saved. With a father who was on the right side of history as publicly documented. The documentation I have about your Kronos arrangement disappears. You get to write whatever you want about what you did during the fracture crisis.

Homelander looks at him for what feels like the longest moment in the film so far.

HOMELANDER

(very controlled)

You planned this from the beginning.

EPSTEIN

I planned for the outcome most likely to be durable. Durability in all fifteen dimensions means sealed fractures and functional governments. I prefer to operate within functional systems rather than collapsed ones.

HOMELANDER
(something cracking
through)
You used me. You used Kronos. You
were never trying to win the war.
You were positioning for the
peace.

EPSTEIN
(simply)
Yes.

Homelander is very still. The stillness before something
breaks.

HOMELANDER
(very quiet, very
dangerous)
Get Ryan.

EPSTEIN
(careful)
What are you going to do?

HOMELANDER
Get. My son.

Epstein stands. He goes to the door. Ryan looks up from
the communication station.

EPSTEIN
(to Ryan, neutral)
Your father is ready.

Ryan comes out. He looks at his father. Homelander looks
at his son. Something moves in Homelander's face that he
cannot control and does not try to.

HOMELANDER
(to Ryan)
Come on. We're leaving.

RYAN
Is everything okay?

HOMELANDER

(looking at Epstein)
It will be.

He takes Ryan's shoulder. He moves them toward the exit.
At the threshold, he stops. He does not turn.

HOMELANDER
(to Epstein, very quiet)
If I find out the documentation
doesn't disappear the way you
said. If I find out any of this
lands on Ryan. There is no
contingency that covers what I do
next.

He and Ryan leave. The pocket dimension reassembles.

Epstein stands alone. He thinks. He picks up his
communications device. He sends one encrypted message.
Three words.

PROCEED TO CENTRAL PARK.

CUT TO:

INT. THE TEMPORAL DOMAIN — KRONOS'S THRONE — SAME NIGHT

Kronos knows. He has always known more than anyone
accounted for. He knows about the Gold. He knows about the
mapping operation. He knows about Epstein's real plan.

He is standing at the center of his throne room,
surrounded by the clocks, and he is letting all fifteen of
them run.

He is letting them run because he is about to stop them.

KRONOS
(to his assistant)
Initiate the cascade. All fifteen
simultaneously. Maximum temporal
pressure on the fracture
boundaries.

ASSISTANT
(alarmed)
Sir – maximum pressure on all
fifteen simultaneously – the
cascade failure model –

KRONOS
Will produce exactly what I want
it to produce. Initiate it.

A pause. The assistant initiates it.

In all fifteen dimensions, the fractures begin to widen.
Not slowly – fast. The kind of fast that turns days into
hours.

ASSISTANT
(reading, voice
dropping)
Dimension Seven – fracture
boundary expansion rate tripled.
Dimension Twelve – critical
status. Dimension Four –
population displacement alarms are
–

KRONOS
(not listening)
How long until cascade point?

ASSISTANT
At this rate – six hours.

KRONOS
Then they have six hours to use
the Gold. Or don't use the Gold
and watch everything end.

He looks at his clocks. All of them running. All of them
counting toward the same moment.

KRONOS
(quietly, to himself)
Let them save it, then. Let them
have their victory. And then we'll

see what Epstein actually built.
And then we'll see what I can
build on top of that.

He closes his eyes.

KRONOS
(barely audible)
Or let it all collapse. Either
way, the cycle ends. Either way, I
get my stillness.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA COMMAND CENTER — EMERGENCY — NIGHT

The alarms hit all stations simultaneously. Seiko reads it
faster than anyone.

SEIKO
(immediately)
All fifteen dimensions. Fracture
cascade initiated. We're looking
at six hours to cascade point.

JOSEPH
(very still)
Kronos.

SEIKO
He accelerated everything. He's
forcing the deployment.

JOSEPH
Six hours.

YARA
The deployment point is Central
Park. The dimensional nexus.

LARRY
(standing)
I'll put out the call. Every ally
across every dimension. Anyone who
can reach Central Park in six

hours –

JOSEPH

Do it.

LARRY activates the Watcher's dimensional broadcast. A signal that goes to all fifteen dimensions simultaneously. An SOS in the oldest dimensional frequency.

And then: response. From everywhere.

On Seiko's display, signals begin appearing around the Central Park coordinates. From the north: Batman's tracking signature, Iron Man's atmospheric scan, Superman's heat trail. From the east: Harry Potter's magical resonance, Gandalf's staff frequency. From the west: Thor's lightning trace, Wonder Woman's shield signal. From the south: Black Panther's vibranium. Aquaman. The Flash. Doctor Strange.

And more. The display filling with signals the way a night sky fills with stars when the clouds clear. Each one a world. Each one a person. Each one a decision made – on the other side of a dimensional barrier – to come.

SEIKO

(voice doing something complicated)

They came.

JOSEPH

(hands flat on console)

All of them.

SEIKO

All of them.

Joseph exhales. He looks at the Gold in his hand. He looks at his people around him.

GUMBALL

(with actual feeling)

So we're doing this.

DARWIN

We're doing this.

JOSEPH
We're doing this.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — JOSEPH'S QUARTERS — ONE HOUR BEFORE DEPLOYMENT
He sits. He has the Gold in one hand and his notebook in the other. He is not writing. He is holding both of them.
A knock.

JOSEPH
Come in.

SEIKO enters. He sits across from Joseph without being invited to, because after everything, invitations are a kind of formality they've moved past.

SEIKO
(quiet)
One hour.

JOSEPH
I know.

A silence.

SEIKO
You're thinking about Epstein.

JOSEPH
I'm thinking about everything.

SEIKO
What specifically about Epstein?

Joseph looks at him. The real answer.

JOSEPH
He's going to be there. Or his people will be. And when I have to choose between deploying the Gold and dealing with him — which takes all of my focus — I don't know if I can do both.

SEIKO
That's what everyone else is for.
You deploy. We handle everything
around it.

JOSEPH
(quietly)
Seiko. If something happens to you
tonight –

SEIKO
Nothing is happening to me
tonight.

JOSEPH
Let me finish. If something
happens to you tonight – I need
you to know that you are the
person who made this possible. Not
the intelligence, not the mapping,
not the analysis – you. The fact
of you. The fact that you were
standing on the landing platform
with Ethiopian blend coffee at
seven in the morning because you
calculated when I'd arrive and
wanted to be there already.

Seiko doesn't say anything.

JOSEPH
My mother said: tell them. It
costs you nothing and it changes
everything. So I'm telling you.

A pause. Seiko is very quiet. When he speaks, his voice
has changed register.

SEIKO
I know.

JOSEPH
Good.

SEIKO
I also know that you're the reason
I'm still here. After the Amber.

JOSEPH
You would have gotten out.

SEIKO
Maybe. But you went over the side
before the maybe could happen. So.

The silence between them is comfortable. The silence of
people who know each other well enough to not need to fill
it.

SEIKO
(standing)
Fifty-three minutes.

JOSEPH
I know. I'm ready.

SEIKO
(at the door, quietly)
Be water.

JOSEPH
(the smallest smile)
Working on it.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — MAIN HALL — THIRTY MINUTES TO DEPLOYMENT

The heroes have been briefed. They know the deployment
point. They know the timeline. They know where the threats
are. Now, in the thirty minutes before they move, YARA
stands before them.

She doesn't use a podium. She stands in the center of the
hall, in the middle of all of them — Avengers and wizards
and warriors and dimensional entities and an animated
cat-boy and a twelve-year-old boy named Darwin who is
genuinely one of the bravest people in any of the fifteen
dimensions.

YARA
I need to tell you something
before we go. Not tactics. You
know the tactics. Something else.

She looks around the room.

YARA
In the last four days I've been
managing the humanitarian response
for six hundred thousand displaced
people across three dimensions. I
know their names. I know which
children are separated from which
families. I know which family in
Dimension Seven has been waiting
nine hours for medical transport.
I know which building in Dimension
Twelve is still standing because
of a decision someone made in that
room two weeks ago.

She pauses.

YARA
We are going tonight to seal
fractures. Dimensional physics.
Numbers on a display. And every
one of those numbers is a person.
A kitchen. A jasmine plant on a
south wall. Someone who has been
bringing someone tea on bad days.
Those are the people we're going
for. Not the event. Not the
victory. Them.

A silence. No one moves.

YARA
When this is over, there is going
to be work to do. The fractures
close but the damage is already

there. There will be rebuilding.
There will be months and years of
the other work – the work nobody
makes speeches about. I want you
to know that's happening. That it
will happen.

She looks at Joseph. He nods.

YARA

Let's go.

SMASH CUT TO:

ACT FOUR: THE FINAL STAND

EXT. NEW YORK CITY – AERIAL APPROACH – NIGHT

The spacecraft descends through early morning sky. New York below – intact skyline. The city holding. The specific stubborn presence of a city that has been through things before and decided each time to continue.

On the instruments: Central Park. Semi-dimensional structure. Partially in normal space, partially in the fracture layer.

SEIKO
(reading instruments)
Epstein is there. In the park.
Thirty-one confirmed operatives.
And –

He stops.

JOSEPH
What?

SEIKO
Kronos. He's there. Partial power
– approximately sixty percent. But
sixty percent of Kronos is still –

JOSEPH
Still Kronos.

SEIKO
And Joseph. The signals around the
perimeter.

He brings up the display. Around the park perimeter at every compass point, signals are appearing. Each one a world. Each one a decision made to come.

Joseph presses both hands flat on the console for a moment. He breathes.

JOSEPH
Set down at the south entrance.
Let us finish this.

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – NEW YORK CITY – NIGHT

The park has been transformed by Kronos's temporal pressure – the trees exist in multiple moments simultaneously, their branches in different seasons visible all at once, summer leaves and bare winter arms occupying the same space. The air is full of dimensional static. Every fracture in every dimension is visible here, like cracks in the surface of reality itself.

And then: the heroes arrive.

From the north, BATMAN drops from a line he fired before he landed. IRON MAN descends in a controlled arc – his armor shifting color in the dimensional light, each facet catching a different timeline. SUPERMAN arrives last, because he was checking the perimeter from above, and the ground practically shakes from his landing.

From the east: GANDALF comes through a dimensional gate, staff raised, HARRY POTTER beside him, HERMIONE and RON flanking.

From the west: THOR comes down in lightning. WONDER WOMAN lands with her shield already raised. Beside her: DOCTOR STRANGE opens a portal and steps through, Sling Ring still smoking.

From everywhere: more. The roster of worlds responding to a frequency that speaks to every hero instinct simultaneously.

EPSTEIN's thirty-one operatives see them coming. They are very good. They are also, it becomes clear immediately, not enough.

But Epstein knew that. He is standing in the center of the park, at the dimensional nexus point, and he is not

attempting to stop them. He is watching.

KRONOS stands beside him, at sixty percent power, which still means standing beside a man who can stop time in a thirty-meter radius.

The battle is enormous. What we track is what matters:

SEIKO at the deployment station, calibrating the deployment mechanism, while the battle rages around him. His hands move with the precision of someone who trained for exactly this moment – because he did. He ran this simulation four hundred times.

GUMBALL and DARWIN running interference, improbably and effectively, with a combination of animation physics and genuine courage. They are not the most powerful beings on this battlefield. They are the most committed.

YARA coordinating the humanitarian extraction of civilians still in the park from a tactical position – doing the other work, even here, even now.

ELEVEN holding back Kronos's temporal field from expanding – her power and his power in direct opposition, both of them straining. Her nose is bleeding. She does not stop.

GANDALF and DOCTOR STRANGE working in concert – magical and dimensional power combined, keeping the temporal field contained. Strange's hands are precise. Gandalf's staff is absolute.

BATMAN working through the operatives with the specific systematic efficiency of someone who does not have superpowers and therefore cannot afford to be imprecise.

SUPERMAN and THOR absorbing the brunt of Kronos's direct temporal assaults – each attack aging them briefly before their regeneration compensates. They do not complain. They hold.

LARRY watching everything, as Watchers do. But at a certain point – when the battle tips and the left flank of the formation begins to break – LARRY makes a decision. He

steps forward. He stops watching. He enters the fight.

It is the first time in this film that a Watcher has chosen. It costs him something that is unclear but visible on his face.

And JOSEPH, moving through all of it, the Gold in his hand, making his way to the nexus point. Where Epstein is waiting.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – THE DIMENSIONAL NEXUS – CONTINUOUS

The nexus point is a circle of still air in the center of everything. The battle continues on all sides. Here, it is nearly quiet.

Joseph walks into the stillness. Epstein is there. Just the two of them, for this moment, in the eye of the storm.

They look at each other. Across a space that contains everything that has happened.

EPSTEIN
(almost quiet)
Joseph.

JOSEPH
(steady)
Jeffrey.

A beat. The world turns around them.

EPSTEIN
You found the Gold. You mapped the infrastructure. You're here with the nexus deployment in hand and what appears to be every significant hero across fifteen dimensions in your corner. You've executed this very well.

JOSEPH
But.

EPSTEIN

But I've also done what I came to do. The real infrastructure is in place. The recovery operation. The genuine one – not the decoy. It's positioned. When these fractures seal, the recovery will run through networks I've established, and I will be embedded in the aftermath of this night for the next decade.

JOSEPH

(quiet)

No.

EPSTEIN

You've mapped the second level.
Not the third.

JOSEPH

Seiko mapped all three levels. He was mapping while he was in the Amber. He was mapping on the Pearl. He was mapping for the seventy-two hours since we returned. All three levels.

Something shifts in Epstein's expression. The first time – the first real time – something moves in it.

JOSEPH

The documentation has been shared with all fifteen dimensional governments. Every position. Every network node. Every financial arrangement. Every person.

Epstein is very still.

JOSEPH

I know this isn't your
destruction. You've survived

things before. You'll find a way to survive this. That's not the point.

EPSTEIN
(controlled)
Then what is the point?

JOSEPH
The point is that the people in the fifteen dimensions get to make informed choices. About who helps them and how. With full information. Which is the one thing you've been taking from people since before this fracture crisis, in fifteen dimensions across however many years you've been doing this.

A long silence between them.

EPSTEIN
(very quiet)
Information doesn't change structural power.

JOSEPH
No. But it changes what people can see. And people who can see have options that people who are blind don't have. It's not perfect. It's not a solution. But it's the difference between a door and a wall.

He looks at Epstein.

JOSEPH
You burned my mother's building. You took her from me. And you thought that would hollow me.

EPSTEIN

(very careful)
It should have.

JOSEPH
She told me to be water. Not hard.
Not brittle. Water bends and comes
back. You gave me the most
devastating possible reason to be
water. I'm going to spend a very
long time not forgiving you for
that.

A beat.

JOSEPH
But I'm also going to spend a very
long time using what she gave me.
Because it turns out that grief,
when you carry it deliberately,
becomes the most durable thing
there is.

He raises the Gold.

JOSEPH
You should leave.

EPSTEIN
(not moving)
I'd rather see this.

JOSEPH
(a beat, almost
surprised)
All right.

He turns to the nexus. He looks at the Gold in his hand –
the size of a closed fist, the light of something very
old, the weight of six days in the Amber and a temple that
asked him to be honest and a sea that took from him the
version of his anger that was holding up his grief.

He places it at the center of the nexus. It connects.

What happens next is not possible to describe in ordinary language. The Gold deploys. The fifteen fractures begin to close – not slowly, not painfully, but with the specific completeness of something that knows what it's doing. Sealing from the inside. The dimensional membranes reknitting.

In all fifteen dimensions: people who were watching the sky see the fractures close.

It looks like watching a wound heal. That fast. That final.

KRONOS feels it. For the first time in as long as he can remember, the clocks in his temporal domain start running at the same speed. All of them. Synchronized. He looks at them for a long moment.

KRONOS
(barely audible, to
himself)
There it is. Stillness.

He looks at the synchronized clocks. He closes his eyes. In Central Park, the last fracture closes.

The Amber dimension's light pulses once – warm, deep gold – visible across all fifteen dimensions simultaneously.

And then: morning.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – DAWN

The park is full of people. Heroes and dimensional entities and a twelve-year-old half-animated boy named Darwin sitting against a tree eating something with perfect contentment. The battle is over. The sky is clear.

Joseph stands at the nexus point. The Gold is gone – not destroyed, not depleted. Absorbed by the dimensional architecture. It went where it was supposed to go.

His hand is empty.

SEIKO
(coming to stand beside
him)
All fifteen fractures sealed.
Confirmed across all dimensional
monitoring networks.

JOSEPH
Epstein?

SEIKO
Gone. Before the Gold finished
deploying. He was watching, and
then he was gone.

JOSEPH
(nodding)
He'll rebuild. Different
dimension, different
infrastructure, different
approach. But the documentation is
out there. The fifteen governments
know what to look for now.

SEIKO
It's not perfect.

JOSEPH
No. But it's different from
before. A door instead of a wall.

They stand in the morning. The park around them slowly
becoming a park again rather than a battlefield.

GUMBALL
(arriving, cereal in
hand)
Okay so I have a lot of questions
about what just happened but the
most pressing one is: is there a
dimension where the cereal never
runs out? Because I feel like that
dimension is the one we should
have been protecting all along.

DARWIN
(high-fiving him)
Good job, Gumball.

GUMBALL
Good job, Darwin.

YARA stands slightly apart, already on her communications device, already coordinating the humanitarian response. ELEVEN watches her and then goes to help.

LARRY watches all of it from the perimeter with the expression of someone who has seen many things and has chosen, this morning, to find this particular collection of things genuinely moving.

JACK SPARROW is at the park edge, looking at his compass. The needle points where it points. He looks at it for a long time. Then he takes out a piece of paper. He writes three words.

Lily. I'm here.

He folds it. He puts it in a dimensional messenger envelope. He sends it. Then he looks at the morning sky. He breathes.

CUT TO:

EXT. CASABLANCA – RUE DES ORANGERS – DAWN

Joseph stands on the street. The same street. The same building. The fourth floor.

The jasmine on the south wall.

Still growing.

He has come back. He always comes back to this street eventually. Not because it contains her – she is not contained in any specific place. But because this is where he can remember most precisely. This is where the inventory is most accurate.

He stands for eleven minutes. He counts.

One. Two. Three.

He breathes.

He does not go inside. He doesn't need to, this time. He has the inventory. He has it with him everywhere now – the ficus, the Quran, the photograph from Fez. The sound the kettle makes. The hand in the margin of the page.

He puts his hand in his pocket. He finds his notebook. The Moroccan flag sticker – faded, present.

He opens it to the line he wrote.

Be water. Not hard. Not brittle. Water bends and comes back.

He reads it. He closes the notebook.

The jasmine sways. The call to prayer begins. The city starts its day with the indifference that is not cruelty.

Joseph Al-Mithali stands on a street in Casablanca in the morning light and understands, in the clearest possible way, that the next thing is whatever comes after the price is paid.

He is water.

He bends. He is already coming back.

SLOW FADE TO BLACK.

**"She told me once: do not let the world make you hard.
Hard things shatter. Soft things bend and come back.
Be water."**

– Fatima Al-Mithali

FADE TO BLACK.

POST-CREDITS SCENE

INT. UNKNOWN LOCATION – UNKNOWN DIMENSION – NIGHT

A room. Clean lines. A desk. One screen. On the screen: financial data moving across multiple dimensions. Not the networks that were exposed. Different networks. Deeper. Built over years.

EPSTEIN sits at the desk. He looks at the screen. He is not frustrated. He is not defeated. He is thinking.

MORRIS enters.

MORRIS

(tentative)

The exposure is – significant. The governments are sharing the documentation. It's being used in dimensional tribunals. Some of the positions are being –

EPSTEIN

(not looking up)

I know.

MORRIS

What do we do?

EPSTEIN

The same thing we always do.

He looks at the screen.

EPSTEIN

We plan.

He reaches up. He turns off the screen. The room goes dark. In the darkness, barely visible – before the screen went dark – a new diagram. A new center point. A new name.

SMASH TO BLACK.

THE PERFECT JOSEPH AND GUMBALL: THE FINAL WAR
PART FOUR: THE FINAL WAR
COMING NEXT

SCORE NOTES – HANS ZIMMER & RYO YOSHIMATA

THE MOTHER THEME: Solo Arabic oud, warm major key, never harmonized. Appears fully only in Act One. Returns as fragment throughout. At film's end, in the post-credits: the only time it plays in full since Fatima's kitchen.

JOSEPH'S THEME: Oud and low strings together. In minor when he carries loss. Shifts to major only when he carries loss forward into action. Never triumphant. Always human.

EPSTEIN'S THEME: No organic instruments. Pure electronic. Precise, metronomic, mathematical. Inverted in the final confrontation when the third level is revealed as already mapped. The one moment we hear what he might have been.

THE AMBER DIMENSION: Single sustained notes on strings. No rhythm. No pulse. The music of crystallized time.

THE BINDING THEME: Full orchestra plus oud. Plays only when the Gold deploys. The one time in the film when all musical themes resolve into each other simultaneously.

THE HOMELANDER THEME: Military brass, slightly wrong. Always in a key that suggests it wants to be major and cannot commit. Resolves to a simple clean major chord only in the moment with Ryan – the one moment he is purely himself.

SOUND DESIGN: The fire – no music. Only fire. The Amber sea – not like water. Something denser, slower, with the sound of frozen moments moving past. The Gold deploying – a tone not in any orchestral tradition. Something between a crystal bowl and a voice. Something that sounds like binding.

DIRECTOR'S STATEMENT – DENIS VILLENEUVE

The emotional spine of this film is not the multiverse. It is a man standing on a street for eleven minutes, counting.

Everything else – the Alps, the void, the desert, the Amber sea, the palace, the weapon, the confrontation – exists to ask and answer one question: what does it cost to carry love forward when the person you loved is gone?

The answer is everything. And the answer is: you do it anyway. Because water bends. Because water comes back. Because the jasmine grows.

That is the film. The rest is scale.

– D.V.

WRITTEN & CREATED BY YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI

Screenplay by CHRISTOPHER NOLAN

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"From one weakness was born infinite power."

INTERLUDE ONE: THE WEIGHT OF SMALL THINGS

INT. HASSAN AL-MITHALI'S APARTMENT — RABAT — DAY

HASSAN AL-MITHALI (55) — ROSHDY ZEM — is watching the news. Every channel has something about the dimensional fractures. He watches the reporters, the graphics, the numbers.

He does not entirely understand the dimensional mechanics. He understands that his son is involved. He understands that it is serious. He understands these things the way a man understands weather when he cannot see the sky — through secondary evidence, through the behavior of other things.

NADIA is with him. She has been here for three days. She brought the kettle.

HASSAN
(to the television)
They keep saying 'unprecedented.'
Everything is unprecedented now.
When I was young, unprecedented
things happened maybe once in a
generation. Now it's three before
breakfast.

NADIA
(pouring tea)
Joseph is handling it.

HASSAN
I know he is. That's not what I'm
worried about.

NADIA
What are you worried about?

A pause. Hassan looks at the television.

HASSAN

That he's handling it alone. That
he's learned to carry things by
himself because he watched me
carry things by myself and thought
that was how it was done.

Nadia sets down the kettle.

NADIA
(quiet)
He's not alone. He has Seiko.

HASSAN
Seiko is good. Seiko is excellent.
But Seiko is not family.

NADIA
Baba. Seiko is absolutely family.

Hassan considers this. He looks at his hands.

HASSAN
(after a long moment)
Your mother would have said the
same thing.

NADIA
(sitting beside him)
Yes. She would have.

They sit together watching the news. The fracture graphics
pulse on the screen. In Rabat, in a small apartment, a
father and daughter wait for news about a son who is
somewhere in the machinery of the world doing what he
does.

HASSAN
(quietly, to himself)
Be water, habibi.

He does not know Joseph writes this in his notebook. He
learned it from the same person Joseph did.

CUT TO:

EXT. DIMENSION FIVE – HOMELANDER'S TERRITORY – NIGHT
ANNIE JANUARY / STARLIGHT – ERIN MORIARTY – is in a surveillance position three hundred meters from Homelander's stronghold. Beside her: BILLY BUTCHER – KARL URBAN – who is doing what Butcher does, which is watching everything with the specific controlled fury of someone who has spent a long time converting hatred into productivity.

STARLIGHT
(through earpiece,
quiet)
He went in. Came out forty-five minutes later with the kid. Ryan. They headed north.

BUTCHER
(taking position)
North means away from the operation. Which means something changed inside.

STARLIGHT
Epstein.

BUTCHER
Epstein. The man who makes Homelander take the kid and leave is not a man you underestimate.

STARLIGHT
Joseph's team has the Gold. I just got the confirmation.

BUTCHER
(something shifting in
his expression)
So it's happening.

STARLIGHT
It's happening. We need to be at Central Park in –

BUTCHER

(standing)
I know. Come on.

A beat. Starlight looks at him.

STARLIGHT
Billy.

BUTCHER
What.

STARLIGHT
(carefully)
Whatever happens at Central Park.
Whatever Homelander does or
doesn't do. We're there for
Joseph. Not for our own things.

Butcher looks at her. A long look.

BUTCHER
(after a moment)
Yeah. Alright.

STARLIGHT
I need the full sentence.

BUTCHER
(almost painful)
We're there for Joseph. Not for
our own things.

STARLIGHT
(small smile)
See. You can do it.

CUT TO:

INT. DIMENSIONAL TRANSIT — GANDALF'S PASSAGE — NIGHT

A dimensional passage — the kind Gandalf has been using
for longer than most of the other heroes have been alive.
HARRY POTTER (in his twenties, dressed practically) is
beside him. They travel in a specific quality of silence.

HARRY

Gandalf. Can I ask you something?

GANDALF

(staff in hand, eyes
forward)

You have been working up to it for
the last twenty minutes. Yes.

HARRY

(a beat)

How do you keep going? After
everything. You've seen things
end. You've been through things
that should have – you've died.
Properly died. How do you keep
being –

GANDALF

(gently)

Yourself?

HARRY

Yes.

Gandalf is quiet for a moment. They walk through the
dimensional passage – light moving around them like water.

GANDALF

When I came back, I was changed. I
do not pretend otherwise. But I
found that the change had not
altered the central thing. The
thing that moves me to action. The
thing that makes a comfortable
chair uncomfortable when there is
something that needs doing.

HARRY

What's the central thing?

GANDALF

(simply)

Care. For specific people. For the
world those specific people

inhabit. For the future those people will inhabit if we do our work correctly now.

Harry thinks about this.

HARRY
Joseph has that.

GANDALF
(a slight smile)
Joseph has it in abundance. It is both his greatest strength and the thing that makes him vulnerable. As it is with all such people.

HARRY
How do you protect that kind of person?

GANDALF
(looking at him)
By standing between them and the things that would use their care against them. Which is precisely what we are going to do tonight.

A beat. Then Harry nods. They walk on through the dimensional passage toward Central Park and whatever waits there.

CUT TO:

INT. IRON MAN'S MOBILE COMMAND – APPROACH TO CENTRAL PARK
– NIGHT

TONY STARK – ROBERT DOWNEY JR. – is in the armor, running diagnostics, running battle projections, running the specific calculations that only Tony runs because only Tony can run them in the time available.

On his communications: BRUCE BANNER – MARK RUFFALO – patched in from a secondary position.

BANNER
(over comms)
Tony. I've been looking at the
dimensional cascade data. The
temporal pressure at the nexus
point when the Gold deploys – the
math suggests –

TONY
(cutting in)
That the person deploying it gets
hit with a significant temporal
backlash. Yeah. I ran that forty
minutes ago.

BANNER
Does Joseph know?

TONY
(a beat)
He knows there's a cost. He
doesn't know the specific
magnitude.

BANNER
Tony –

TONY
I know, Bruce. I know.

A silence.

TONY
(quieter)
The backlash is survivable. I ran
the numbers six times. It's
survivable. It's not nothing. But
it's survivable.

BANNER
Are you sure?

TONY
(the voice of someone
who has double and

triple-checked something
hoping the answer would
change)
Ninety-one percent sure. Which in
these circumstances is as close to
certain as we get.

BANNER
And the other nine percent?

A long silence. The armor moves through New York airspace.
Below: Central Park approaching.

TONY
Is why I'm going to be right
there. In case we need a
contingency.

BANNER
(quietly)
I'll be there too.

TONY
(the way he says things
when they matter)
I know.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK PERIMETER — NORTH ENTRANCE — NIGHT
WOLVERINE — HUGH JACKMAN — and CAPTAIN AMERICA — CHRIS
EVANS — are at the north perimeter. Pre-battle. Both of
them in the specific state of readiness that comes from
having done this before — many times, across many fights,
in different contexts with different stakes but always
with the same fundamental quality.

STEVE
(looking at the park)
You've met Joseph before. What's
your read?

LOGAN

(arms crossed)
Solid. Not flashy solid – actually
solid. The kind of solid that
comes from deciding something and
not undeciding it when it gets
hard.

STEVE

Like?

LOGAN

Like: he decided to be the person
who carries things. And then his
mother died. And then he came back
and kept carrying things. That's
the specific kind of solid that
counts.

Steve nods.

STEVE

Epstein.

LOGAN

(jaw tightening)
Yeah.

STEVE

He's in there.

LOGAN

I know.

STEVE

Logan. Whatever you feel about –

LOGAN

(sharp)
I know, Steve. I'm not going to –

STEVE

I know you're not. I'm saying: I
know what it's like to want the
thing you want when someone like
Epstein is in front of you. I'm

saying I understand it.

A pause. Wolverine looks at him.

LOGAN
(quieter)
What do you do with it?

STEVE
(simply)
I hold it. And I do the work. And
I hold it some more.

Logan breathes. He uncrosses his arms. His claws retract –
he wasn't aware they'd extended.

LOGAN
How long does it take? For that to
get easier?

STEVE
(honest)
I'll let you know when it does.

They stand there for a moment at the perimeter. Then the
signal comes. And they move.

CUT TO:

INTERLUDE TWO: AMBER NIGHTS

EXT. THE BLACK PEARL – DECK – AMBER DIMENSION – NIGHT

The Pearl is anchored for the night – or what passes for night in the Amber Dimension, which is a deepening of the amber light into something darker, something that approximates night the way the Amber approximates water.

JACK and SEIKO are on deck. Joseph is below, sleeping – actually sleeping, which Jack insisted on because the Temple trials require full cognitive capacity and sleep deprivation is the enemy of cognitive capacity.

Jack is drinking. Seiko is not drinking. Seiko is running calculations on his tablet with one hand and watching the amber sky with the other.

SEIKO

(not looking up from
tablet)

Can I ask you something personal?

JACK

(drinking)

People who ask if they can ask something personal have already decided to ask it. The question is a formality. Ask.

SEIKO

In the Amber. When you came in the first time. For the girl – for Lily. Were you afraid?

JACK

(a beat)

Terrified. The Amber Dimension is among the five most hostile environments I've personally navigated. And I've navigated the

Maelstrom, which actually killed me temporarily, and a kraken, which also killed me temporarily, and several situations that should have killed me permanently but chose not to.

SEIKO
But you went anyway.

JACK
But I went anyway.

SEIKO
Why?

Jack looks at his bottle. Then at the amber sky.

JACK
Because the alternative was not going. And not going would have been a decision I'd have to carry. And in my experience, decisions you make because you were afraid are heavier than decisions you make despite being afraid.

SEIKO
(quiet)
The topology of regret.

JACK
(looking at him)
That's a very precise way of describing it.

SEIKO
I think about it a lot. Which decisions create which weights. How to minimize the weight of the ones I make when I'm afraid.

JACK
And what have you concluded?

SEIKO
(after a moment)
That the best approach is to make
the decision before you know
you're afraid of it. Make it so
early in the process that the fear
arrives after the commitment. Then
you're not choosing despite fear.
You're honoring a commitment you
made before the fear was relevant.

Jack stares at him.

JACK
How old are you?

SEIKO
Nineteen.

JACK
(to himself)
Nineteen.

SEIKO
(looking at the sky)
Joseph is the same way. He decided
to be the person who carries
things before he understood what
carrying things cost. And now the
cost is known and he's still the
person who decided.

JACK
(gently)
You're proud of him.

SEIKO
(simply)
He's the best person I know.
That's not complicated for me.

They sit with that for a while. The amber sky. The
crystallized time moving around them. Two people staying
awake so a third can sleep.

CUT TO:

INT. THE AMBER DIMENSION – JOSEPH'S DREAM – NIGHT

JOSEPH sleeps. In the Amber Dimension, sleeping is different from sleeping in normal space. The crystallized time around the Pearl bleeds into unconscious thought, and what dreams come are not quite dreams.

JOSEPH IS WALKING. Through a city – Casablanca, but not quite, the way dreams approximate places rather than reproduce them exactly. The streets are wider than they should be. The light is the amber light.

His MOTHER is ahead of him. Walking. He follows.

JOSEPH
(calling, in Arabic)
Mama. Wait.

She keeps walking. He walks faster. She turns a corner. He turns the corner.

She is at the apartment building. She is at the door. She turns to look at him.

FATIMA
(in Arabic, smiling)
You found me.

JOSEPH
(in Arabic)
I always find you.

FATIMA
No. You carry me. That's different. You carry me everywhere.

He reaches her. The building behind her is the building, the jasmine on the wall, the fourth floor window.

JOSEPH
(barely)
I miss you.

FATIMA
(simply)
I know. You are allowed to miss me
and continue. Those are not
contradictory things.

JOSEPH
I know. You told me.

FATIMA
I'm going to tell you again,
because you'll need to hear it
again when you wake up.

She looks at him with the look. The specific,
irreplaceable look.

FATIMA
You are allowed to miss me and
continue. You are allowed to carry
me and still put down other
things. You are allowed to grieve
and still find things worth being
glad about.

JOSEPH
(eyes closing in the
dream)
What things?

FATIMA
(warmth in her voice)
The boy who makes coffee at seven
in the morning. The girl who runs
the numbers because she cannot
stop running the numbers. The
animated child who eats cereal
with total commitment. The pirate
who loves someone and is too
afraid to say it.

A beat.

FATIMA

These things. Be glad about these things.

Joseph opens his eyes in the dream. She is already walking back into the building. He watches her go.

He does not follow. He watches.

The jasmine on the south wall sways in a breeze that is not a breeze but is the amber moving around a sleeping ship.

Joseph wakes up.

INT. THE BLACK PEARL – BELOW DECKS – CONTINUOUS

He wakes. He is in the Amber Dimension. The ship is still. Seiko and Jack's voices are audible above, quiet, continuing their watch.

Joseph lies still for a moment. Then he sits up. He takes his notebook. He writes:

Be glad. About the specific things. The ones that are here. The ones that chose.

He closes the notebook. He lies back down. He sleeps again, this time without dreaming.

CUT TO:

INT. EPSTEIN'S SAFEHOUSE – PRIVATE ROOM – NIGHT

A room within the safehouse that Morris has never entered. Epstein's private space within his private space.

He is not working. This is unusual.

He is sitting in a chair, and he is not working, and the lack of work has a quality to it – the quality of someone who has, for the first time in a long time, stopped.

On the desk: a single photograph. Not a surveillance photograph. Not intelligence. A photograph.

A boy, six years old. In a garden somewhere. The boy is laughing at something outside the frame. The photograph is old – twenty years, more.

Epstein looks at the photograph for a very long time.

EPSTEIN
(to himself, barely
audible)
You would have been twenty-six
now.

He does not elaborate. He does not explain who the boy is. We do not learn. This is the one piece of Epstein's architecture that no one else has access to, that appears in no intelligence report, that he has never used and never will use as leverage on anyone.

He looks at the photograph for another long moment. Then he puts it face-down on the desk.

He stands. He smooths his jacket. He returns to the outer room. Morris is there.

MORRIS
(tentative)
Sir. There's been a development in
the Dimension Four situation.

EPSTEIN
(back to being himself
immediately)
Tell me.

Morris tells him. Epstein listens. He begins to work again. Whatever was in that room stays in that room.

He never mentions the boy. We never learn the boy's name.

Some things even Epstein keeps only for himself.

CUT TO:

INTERLUDE THREE: THE MACHINERY OF THE WORLD

INT. THE TEMPORAL DOMAIN – KRONOS'S PRIVATE CHAMBER – DAY
The ASSISTANT – whose name is PETRA, which Kronos has never used – is working at the temporal instruments. She has worked for Kronos for eleven years. She knows things about him that no one else knows.

KRONOS enters. He is not dressed for the throne room. He is dressed for nothing in particular, which is rarer than anyone realizes.

PETRA
(without turning)
The cascade preparation is at
seventy-three percent. Full
capability in sixteen hours.

KRONOS
(sitting – not at the
throne, at a secondary
chair)
Tell me something.

Petra turns, surprised. Kronos sitting at the secondary chair is unusual.

PETRA
(carefully)
What would you like to know?

KRONOS
You've worked for me for eleven
years. In that time, you've seen
me make decisions that have –
consequences. Not small ones. And
you've continued to work for me.
Why?

Petra is very careful. She knows what honest answers cost in this environment. She gives one anyway.

PETRA

(measured)

Because I believed, when I began,
that what you wanted – stillness –
was achievable through means that
would not require the end of
everything to achieve it.

KRONOS

And now?

PETRA

(long pause)

Now I'm less certain.

A silence. Kronos looks at the temporal instruments.

KRONOS

When I was very young – younger
than the current dimensional
architecture, which gives you a
sense of the scale – I watched a
universe. The first universe. Not
one of the fifteen. Something
before. Something that had found a
kind of equilibrium. Not static,
not dead, but – settled. The way a
deep lake settles after a storm.

PETRA

(very still)

What happened to it?

KRONOS

It continued. For a very long time
it continued in its equilibrium.
And then it didn't. It had a
breaking point – everything has a
breaking point – and it reached
it. And when it broke, it broke
everything in it simultaneously.
Nothing survived.

He looks at his hands.

KRONOS

I have spent everything since then
trying to find a way to stop the
cycle. I have tried twelve
different approaches in eleven
different dimensional systems.
None of them worked. This is the
thirteenth.

PETRA

(quietly)

Do you think this one will?

KRONOS

(very long pause)

No.

Petra stares.

KRONOS

But I find I cannot stop trying.
Which is its own kind of cycle, I
suppose.

He stands. He goes to the instruments. He begins to work.
Petra watches him for a moment.

PETRA

(very quietly)

Kronos. There's a boy in
Casablanca.

Kronos pauses.

PETRA

Joseph Al-Mithali. He lost his
mother. He carried that loss and
made it into something functional.
He's trying to save things instead
of stop them. There might be –

KRONOS

(quietly)

I know what he's trying to do.

PETRA

Then you know it might be worth –

KRONOS

(back to the
instruments)

Leave me, Petra.

She leaves. Kronos stands at the instruments. He is very still. He looks at the cascade preparation data.

He thinks about a universe, long ago, that found equilibrium. That held it, for a very long time.

He thinks about a boy in Casablanca who waters plants even when he doesn't feel like it.

The preparation continues.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA – RESEARCH WING – DAY

HERMIONE GRANGER – EMMA WATSON – has been in the research wing for six hours. She is not an official MPA researcher. She arrived with a specific purpose: the dimensional fracture patterns contain something she recognized from theoretical dimensional magic – a framework that Hogwarts' library calls the 'Binding Problem,' which was considered theoretical.

SEIKO finds her there. He stops in the doorway, looking at what she's assembled.

SEIKO

(entering carefully)

You've been here since – that's a six-hour research trail.

HERMIONE

(not looking up)

Your temporal fracture patterns are identical in structure to a

theoretical magical framework
called the Binding Problem. It's
described in a 1632 manuscript by
Cornelius Agrippa's dimensional
correspondent – I've had a copy
for two years but always
considered it theoretical.

SEIKO
(moving closer)
What does the framework say?

HERMIONE
It says that dimensional
separation is maintained by what
the manuscript calls 'binding
energy' – a force that exists
between dimensions to keep them
distinct. When binding energy is
depleted –

SEIKO
(quietly)
Fractures.

HERMIONE
(looking at him)
The Weezy Gold – I've been reading
your data on it – the Gold is
binding energy in material form.
Which means when Joseph deploys it
at the nexus –

SEIKO
He's not just sealing the
fractures. He's replenishing the
binding energy in all fifteen
dimensions simultaneously.

HERMIONE
Yes. Which also means –

SEIKO

(finishing)
The backlash. When the Gold
releases that much binding energy
at once, whoever is holding it –

They look at each other. The weight of this understanding
settling between two very intelligent people who have both
just realized the same thing.

HERMIONE
(carefully)
Does Joseph know?

SEIKO
(very quiet)
Not the full magnitude.

HERMIONE
Seiko –

SEIKO
I know. I'm going to tell him. I
just need –

He stops. He needs a moment. He has been running so much
analysis for so many hours that this specific moment –
where the analysis produces a result he does not want –
requires more than a moment.

SEIKO
(steading)
I'm going to tell him. Before we
go.

HERMIONE
(gently)
He'll still go.

SEIKO
(barely)
I know.

A pause.

SEIKO

That's not the hard part. The hard part is that there's nothing I can do to change the math.

HERMIONE
(quiet, understanding)
I'm sorry.

Seiko looks at the research trail. He looks at the data. He straightens. He begins to calculate contingencies – because that is what Seiko does when he cannot change the central variable. He calculates everything around it.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA – JOSEPH'S QUARTERS – NIGHT

Joseph is packing. Seiko enters. He closes the door behind him. The specific way he closes the door tells Joseph this is a conversation, not a briefing.

JOSEPH
(turning)
What?

Seiko stands. He has run this conversation in his head seventeen times in the last hour. None of the versions are good. He gives the honest one.

SEIKO
The Gold deploys binding energy.
When it releases at the nexus –
the full binding energy of all
fifteen dimensions at once – the
person holding it takes the
backlash of all fifteen
dimensional restoration events
simultaneously.

Joseph is very still.

JOSEPH
(quietly)
How bad.

SEIKO
(this is the part he
doesn't want to say)
Hermione and I ran it six times.
Tony Stark ran it independently
and got the same result.
Ninety-one percent survivable.

JOSEPH
And the nine percent.

SEIKO
(barely)
Is not survivable.

A silence. Joseph looks at him. Then he turns back to his
packing. He continues packing.

SEIKO
(from behind him)
Joseph.

JOSEPH
(packing)
I'm thinking.

SEIKO
I know.

A minute of silence. Joseph packs.

JOSEPH
(finally)
Is there a way to reduce the nine
percent?

SEIKO
Hermione is working on a magical
dampening framework. Tony is
working on an armor configuration.
Combined, they might bring it to
four or five percent.

JOSEPH
Do that. Both of them.

SEIKO
Already told them to.

Another pause.

JOSEPH
(not turning)
Seiko. Who knows about this?

SEIKO
Me. Hermione. Tony. Bruce Banner.
And now you.

JOSEPH
Keep it that way. Yara doesn't
need this information. Darwin
doesn't need it. Gumball
definitely doesn't need it.

SEIKO
(tight)
Joseph –

JOSEPH
(turning now)
I'm not being reckless. I'm being
accurate. The nine percent – or
five percent – is real. But it's
mine to carry. It doesn't help
anyone else to carry it with me.

Seiko looks at him. The specific look of someone who
disagrees and knows the argument is lost.

SEIKO
(after a very long
moment)
Okay.

JOSEPH
Thank you for telling me.

SEIKO
I wasn't going to not tell you.

JOSEPH

(quietly)
I know. That's why you're you.

Seiko turns to go. At the door:

SEIKO
(very quiet)
Joseph. The ninety-one percent.
That's where we're going. That's
what I'm going to spend every
minute between now and the
deployment making bigger.

JOSEPH
(simply)
I know.

SEIKO
Okay.

He leaves. Joseph looks at his packed bag. He picks up his notebook. He opens it to the line he always opens it to.

**Be water. Not hard. Not brittle. Water bends and comes
back.**

He reads it. He closes it. He finishes packing.

CUT TO:

INTERLUDE FOUR: THE BATTLE OF CENTRAL PARK – EXPANDED

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – EAST SIDE – BATTLE – NIGHT

BATMAN and IRON MAN working the east side. They have never worked together before. They discover, immediately, that they have certain things in common – the thing where you're the one without superpowers and you therefore cannot afford to be imprecise.

TONY
(over comms, aerial)
Your twelve o'clock. Three
operatives. High-yield dimensional
disruptors. I'd take the one on
the left.

BATMAN
(already moving)
I have them.

TONY
(pausing)
I said I'd take –

BATMAN
(three operatives
already down)
They're handled.

A beat.

TONY
(impressed despite
himself)
How long did that take you?

BATMAN
(flat)
Four point three seconds.

TONY

I could have done it in three
point eight.

BATMAN
You were talking.

A pause. Then something that might be Tony Stark's
equivalent of being charmed.

TONY
(over comms)
Okay, I like this guy.

BATMAN
(already moving to next
position)
We have a southeast pocket
forming. Your side.

TONY
(moving)
On it. You're not bad, by the way.

BATMAN
(moving)
I'm aware.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK — WEST SIDE — BATTLE — NIGHT
WONDER WOMAN — GAL GADOT — and BLACK PANTHER — CHADWICK
BOSEMAN — holding the west perimeter. Two warriors from
two very different traditions finding, in the field, a
rhythm that is almost choreographic.

T'CHALLA
(moving)
The temporal field is expanding
west. If it reaches the perimeter
—

DIANA
(already moving toward
it)

It won't.

She raises her shield against the temporal expansion. The shield – blessed by Hephaestus – absorbs temporal energy in ways it was not specifically designed for but manages anyway, because things blessed by gods tend to exceed their specifications.

T'Challa flanks the field. The vibranium suit reads the temporal frequency and adapts.

T'CHALLA
(straining)
Hold.

DIANA
(holding)
Holding.

The temporal field pushes. They push back. Around them: the battle. Above them: the sky beginning to show the faintest fracture lines as Kronos's cascade reaches its peak pressure.

T'CHALLA
(over the strain)
We need to hold for eight more
minutes. Until Joseph reaches the
nexus.

DIANA
(resolute)
Eight minutes. We've held longer.

They hold. The park bends time around them. They don't move.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – SOUTH SIDE – BATTLE – NIGHT

GUMBALL and DARWIN, in the thick of it. What they can do: they can take hits that would damage other fighters without permanent consequence, because animation physics

don't behave like normal physics. What this means in practice: they are extremely hard to incapacitate.

An operative fires a dimensional disruptor at Darwin. It hits him. He bounces back – literally, like animation physics – and comes back angrier.

DARWIN
(bouncing back, then
indignant)
That was rude.

GUMBALL
(running interference)
Very rude. We try to have a
civilized battle here.

Another operative grabs Gumball. Gumball stretches – he has a little of that quality, in the animated space between their two realities – and simply extends until the grip loses purchase, then contracts.

GUMBALL
Also rude. Darwin, note the
rudeness.

DARWIN
(notepad somehow
appearing)
Noted. Volume of rudeness:
significant.

They are, objectively, doing extremely well. But they are also working toward something. Something deliberate.

What they are working toward: there is a secondary dimensional disruptor array positioned to interrupt Seiko's deployment station. Epstein's people placed it an hour before the battle. They are the only ones who have identified it, because they're small enough and fast enough to have moved through the battle in ways the larger heroes couldn't.

DARWIN

(to Gumball, serious
now)
East of the deployment station.
Sixty meters. That's the array.

GUMBALL
(dropping the comedy)
I see it.

DARWIN
If it fires while Seiko is
calibrating –

GUMBALL
It doesn't fire. We make sure of
that.

They look at each other. The look of two people who have
been together long enough to communicate entire plans in a
glance.

Then they move toward it.

What they do next is not rude at all. What they do next is
extraordinary.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – DEPLOYMENT STATION – BATTLE – NIGHT
SEIKO at the station. His hands moving. The battle is
everywhere around him. Three things are happening
simultaneously in Seiko's mind:

One: the deployment sequence, which he has run four
hundred times and which must be executed with exact
precision at the exact moment Joseph places the Gold.

Two: the dampening framework from Hermione, which he is
integrating into the deployment sequence in real time,
because Hermione finished it seventeen minutes ago and it
wasn't previously part of the plan.

Three: the awareness, constant and specific, of exactly
where Joseph is in relation to the nexus.

YARA appears at his shoulder. She is not supposed to be here – she is supposed to be at the humanitarian coordination station. She is here anyway.

SEIKO
(not looking up)
You're supposed to be at the –

YARA
I delegated. Ellison has it.

SEIKO
Yara –

YARA
(firmly)
Seiko. I am staying here. Tell me what you need.

A beat. Seiko looks at his station. He makes a calculation.

SEIKO
The dampening framework –
Hermione's component – needs to be synchronized manually with the deployment trigger at the moment of Gold placement. I can't do both with two hands.

YARA
Tell me exactly what to do.

SEIKO
(moving fast)
When I say 'now' – this lever, exactly ninety degrees, counter-clockwise, and hold it there until the light changes from amber to gold. Do not let go before the light changes.

YARA
Understood.

SEIKO
If you let go before –

YARA
(steady)
I won't. Tell me when.

Seiko looks at her for one moment. He looks at where Joseph is – crossing the park toward the nexus, the Gold in his hand, moving through the battle like water around obstacles.

The moment is coming.

SEIKO
(hands moving)
Ready?

YARA
(hands on the lever)
Ready.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – CENTER – ELEVEN VS KRONOS – NIGHT

The temporal field is Kronos's main weapon here. He is not fighting directly – he is doing something more dangerous, which is expanding the temporal field to cover the nexus point, so that when the Gold is placed, the time distortion will scatter the binding energy rather than allow it to cohere.

ELEVEN is the only one who can stop this. She knows this. She has known it since Seiko explained the deployment mechanics four hours ago.

She is standing between Kronos and the nexus point. Her power pushing against his. Her nose is bleeding. She does not stop.

KRONOS
(from behind the field)
You're very strong. For someone
your age.

ELEVEN
(pushing back)
Strong enough.

KRONOS
This is not personal, child. I'm
not angry at you. I'm not angry at
anyone. I simply want something
that cannot coexist with
everything else continuing.

ELEVEN
(straining)
Then – want – something – else.

A pause. The temporal field pushes. Eleven holds.

KRONOS
(quieter)
I've been trying, for a very long
time, to want something else.

ELEVEN
(very strained)
Try – harder.

He pushes. She holds. She does something she hasn't done
in this fight yet: she calls on the thing she has been
most careful with, the deepest level of her ability, the
thing she saves for when nothing else works.

The temporal field stops expanding. It begins to contract.

KRONOS feels it. He pushes harder.

ELEVEN pushes harder.

Her nose is bleeding significantly now. She does not
notice. She is focused entirely on the field. She is
thinking, as she pushes, of the six hundred thousand
displaced people in Dimension Seven. The specific human
mass of six hundred thousand lives. She is pushing for
each of them individually and all of them simultaneously.

The field holds. It does not reach the nexus.

GANDALF and DOCTOR STRANGE arrive at her flanks. They add their power to hers. Three together.

The field contracts further.

Kronos, for the first time, looks uncertain.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – APPROACH TO NEXUS – NIGHT

Joseph is forty meters from the nexus. Twenty. Ten.

Around him: the battle. The heroes holding. Eleven holding the temporal field. Seiko at the station. Yara with her hand on the lever.

The Gold in his hand pulses. It can feel the nexus approaching. It knows.

Joseph is thinking, as he walks those last ten meters, about something specific: the inventory.

The ficus. The Quran with the handwriting in the margins. The photograph from Fez – her mid-sentence, caught in a moment of pure being. The sound the kettle makes. The jasmine on the south wall of the cream-colored building.

He is thinking: these things still exist. The jasmine is still growing. The Quran is still on the shelf, her handwriting in the margins. The ficus is leaning toward a sun that is still rising every morning.

These things still exist and will continue to exist.

He is five meters from the nexus.

He is thinking: and so will everything in those fifteen dimensions. Because of this. Because of now.

Three meters.

He thinks: be water.

Two meters.

He thinks: I'm water.

One meter.

He steps into the nexus.

SEIKO
(at the station,
watching)
Now.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK — THE DIMENSIONAL NEXUS — THE MOMENT —
NIGHT

Joseph places the Gold at the center of the nexus.

What happens next is both instantaneous and the longest
moment in the film.

The Gold — which has been warm since he took it from the
Temple, which has been pulsing like something alive — goes
incandescent. The light it produces is not in any spectrum
visible to normal human eyes. The IMAX cameras capture it
anyway. It is the color of binding. The color of something
very old recognizing what it was made for.

From the nexus: fifteen beams of light. One for each
dimension. They travel outward in all directions
simultaneously — not through normal space but through the
dimensional space between worlds, finding each fracture
with the unerring accuracy of something that knows where
it needs to go.

In Dimension Seven: the fracture closes. A family of four,
sheltering in a building that has been tilting for three
days because its foundations are in the fracture zone —
they feel the building straighten. They look at each
other. They have no words for what just happened. They do
not need words.

In Dimension Twelve: the fracture closes. The crystallized
time in the Narrows — the frozen figures Joseph saw
passing — they release. Not all at once. One by one. A man
in mid-stride. A woman reaching for something. A child

mid-laugh. They are free.

In Dimension One: the fracture closes. Central Park's trees stop existing in multiple seasons simultaneously. They settle into this one. Spring, because that is what the park's temporal orientation returns to when the distortion lifts.

In all fifteen dimensions: the fractures close.

JOSEPH stands at the nexus. The Gold is releasing everything it held. He is the conduit. The backlash hits.

What the backlash feels like: fifteen dimensions of binding energy returning simultaneously. Fifteen versions of restoration, each one involving the specific loss and recovery that produced the fracture in the first place. All of it, through the person holding the Gold.

Joseph does not fall. He bends.

Be water.

The light is extraordinary. It is the light of something being healed. He is inside it. He is the center of it.

And then it is done.

The Gold is gone. Absorbed.

The light fades.

Joseph is standing at the nexus. He is breathing. He is conscious.

He is ninety-one percent.

The temporal dampening framework worked. Hermione's component. Yara's lever. Tony's armor configuration, which descended around Joseph in the last five seconds – Tony made a decision that cost him something but was not close to a question.

Joseph is standing. His legs are unsteady. He catches himself. He stands.

He breathes.

He is water.

He came back.

SMASH CUT TO:

INTERLUDE FIVE: WHAT COMES AFTER

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – AFTER – DAWN

KRONOS is still. The temporal field is gone. The clocks in his domain are synchronized for the first time in his memory.

ELEVEN stands before him. The battle is over. She is bleeding and breathing hard and she has not moved from her position between him and the nexus.

KRONOS
(looking at the morning
sky)
You held.

ELEVEN
(quietly)
Yes.

KRONOS
I thought you might not.

ELEVEN
I did.

A very long silence. The park around them finding its morning rhythm.

KRONOS
(quieter than he has
been)
The stillness. The synchronized
clocks.

ELEVEN

Yes?

KRONOS
(very quietly)
It's not unpleasant.

Eleven looks at him. He looks at the morning sky.
Something in him is different from the man who initiated
the cascade.

KRONOS
(to himself, barely)
Perhaps it doesn't require
everything to end.

He does not elaborate. He begins to walk.

ELEVEN
(calling after him)
Where are you going?

He stops but does not turn.

KRONOS
(very quiet)
Somewhere to think. There appear
to be things I have not fully
considered.

He goes. Eleven watches him. She does not stop him. She
makes a decision about him that is not a certainty but is
a direction.

CUT TO:

EXT. DIMENSION THREE – RYAN'S YARD – DAWN

The fractures have closed. In Dimension Three, the world
looks – cleaner. The specific visible relief of a sky that
has been threatening something for weeks and has decided
not to.

RYAN is in the yard. He does not have his handlers with
him this morning – they have been redirected by
Homelander's standing instructions.

HOMELANDER lands in the yard. Ryan looks up. He is a twelve-year-old boy. He looks at his father the way twelve-year-old boys look at their fathers – complicated, searching, hoping for something specific.

RYAN
Dad. Did you see the sky? The fractures are gone.

HOMELANDER
(looking at his son)
Yeah. I saw.

RYAN
Who fixed them?

A pause. Homelander looks at his son. He thinks about what Epstein said. He thinks about the documentation. He thinks about what he wants Ryan to inherit.

HOMELANDER
(measured)
A lot of people. Working together.
Joseph Al-Mithali led it.

RYAN
I've heard of him. The Perfect Joseph.

HOMELANDER
Yeah.

RYAN
Were you – were you part of it?
Did you help?

The longest beat. Homelander looks at his son. He thinks about the honest answer. He thinks about what the honest answer costs.

HOMELANDER
(finally, carefully)
I made some decisions. Not all of them were the right ones.

Ryan looks at him.

RYAN
(twelve years old, very
serious)
But you're trying to make better
ones.

It is not a question. It is something more complicated – a statement that is also a question that is also an offering of the thing Homelander has been trying to get from this boy since the boy was born.

HOMELANDER
(barely)
Yeah. I am.

RYAN
(nodding)
Okay.

He goes back to the basketball. He shoots. The ball goes through the hoop. He gets it and shoots again.

Homelander stands in his son's yard and watches his son play basketball and does not destroy anything.

This is a beginning.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA – COMMAND CENTER – POST-BATTLE – DAY

Twelve hours after the deployment. The command center has transformed – no longer a crisis management station, now a recovery coordination hub. Different energy. Still intense, but with direction now instead of emergency.

YARA is running the recovery. She has not slept. She will sleep when the immediate crisis is managed and not before.

SEIKO is beside her. He has also not slept. His instruments are now running recovery data instead of fracture data.

SEIKO

(reading)
Dimension Seven – humanitarian
response is reaching the eastern
quadrant. The first supplies
landed forty minutes ago.

YARA
The family that was waiting nine
hours?

SEIKO
Reunited. Twenty minutes ago.

Yara stops typing for a moment. Just a moment.

YARA
(very quiet)
Good.

She goes back to work.

SEIKO
(after a moment)
Yara. The cross-dimensional mutual
aid network – Ellison's framework
–

YARA
I've already begun the
implementation. It's going to take
six weeks to build properly. But
it will be built properly.

SEIKO
(a beat)
When you said 'we keep working.'
On the observation deck.

YARA
(not stopping work)
Yes?

SEIKO
I've been thinking about that.
About what 'we keep working' looks

like after this.

YARA

And?

SEIKO

(deciding)

I want to build something. A system. Real-time dimensional humanitarian intelligence. So that the next time something threatens populations across multiple dimensions – and there will be a next time – we know sooner. We respond faster.

Yara looks at him. The look of someone who has found a collaborator.

YARA

I want to help build that.

SEIKO

I was hoping you'd say that.

YARA

I was going to say it regardless of your hope.

SEIKO

(the faintest smile)

I know. That's why I was hoping.

CUT TO:

INT. DIMENSIONAL CAFÉ – DIMENSION FOUR – MORNING

A café that exists at a dimensional crossroads – the kind of place where the coffee is excellent because it's made from beans grown in three different dimensions simultaneously.

LILY (27) – red-haired, ink-stained, carrying three books under one arm, dressed like someone who spends a lot of

time in places that are not designed for comfort – is sitting at a corner table with her three books and her research notes and her coffee.

She is in the middle of writing something when she hears the door. She does not look up.

JACK sits across from her.

She looks up.

LILY
(not surprised, which is
itself telling)
You sent a letter.

JACK
I sent three words.

LILY
'Lily. I'm here.' is three words.

JACK
Yes.

A pause. She looks at him. He looks at her. This is a look that has been building for six years across various dimensional ports and one Amber Dimension extraction and approximately forty letters.

LILY
(carefully)
Where have you been?

JACK
The Amber Dimension. Navigating.

LILY
(eyes going very still)
You went back in.

JACK
Someone needed to reach the Temple
of Binding.

LILY
(very quiet)

Jack.

JACK

They needed to seal fifteen dimensional fractures. The Gold was at the Temple. I was the only navigator. It was not a complicated decision.

LILY

(with feeling)

It's an extremely complicated decision. You nearly died in there the first time.

JACK

I nearly die in a lot of places. I have an excellent track record for surviving it.

A pause. She looks at him. He looks at her.

LILY

(the real question)

Why are you here, Jack?

He takes out the compass. He puts it on the table between them. The needle points, as it always points. Directly at her.

She looks at the compass. She looks at the needle. She looks at him.

JACK

(very quietly)

Someone told me recently that the most honest thing you can do is let someone know they matter to you. He said: tell them. It costs you nothing and it changes everything.

Lily looks at the compass for a long time.

LILY

(barely)
How long has it been pointing
there?

JACK
Six years, approximately.

A very long silence. The café around them. Three
dimensions of coffee beans. The compass on the table.

LILY
(finally, voice doing
something complicated)
You should have told me six years
ago.

JACK
Yes.

LILY
You are an extremely difficult
man.

JACK
Yes.

LILY
(looking at the compass)
I've been writing letters to you
for six years.

JACK
I know.

LILY
Forty-three letters.

JACK
I know. I kept all of them.

She looks at him. Then she pushes her books aside to make
room at the table. She picks up her coffee. She doesn't
hand him back the compass.

LILY

Sit properly. Tell me about the
Temple.

He sits properly. He tells her about the Temple. It takes
a long time.

The compass sits on the table between them. The needle
doesn't move.

CUT TO:

EXT. DIMENSION ONE — CENTRAL PARK — THE DAY AFTER —
MORNING

The park is returning to normal. Or the version of normal
that follows an event of this magnitude — which is not the
same normal as before, because things that have been
through a fracture crisis are not the same as things that
haven't. But they are still here. They continue.

GANDALF and FRODO BAGGINS — ELIJAH WOOD — walk through the
park. Frodo is moving a little slowly — the dimensional
transit was not easy for him — but he is here and he is
walking and the grass is green and the sky is clear and
the fractures are gone.

FRODO
(looking around)
It's very big. For a park.

GANDALF
Most things in this particular
dimension are very big. They find
it reassuring.

FRODO
Do you think Joseph will be
alright?

GANDALF
Yes. He has the specific quality
of being alright. Not without
cost. Not without the weight of
what he carries. But alright

nonetheless.

FRODO
(quiet)
I know something about that.

GANDALF
(gently)
I know you do.

They walk. The park around them. Spring light.

FRODO
Gandalf. When I destroyed the Ring
– when it was over – I kept
thinking I would feel lighter.
That the absence of it would feel
like rest.

GANDALF
And did it?

FRODO
Not exactly. It felt like – having
been used for something important.
Like a tool that has been used
correctly. The tool doesn't rest.
It just waits for the next thing
it's needed for.

Gandalf looks at him.

GANDALF
That is a very precise description
of what I have always felt after
the significant moments.

FRODO
(small)
Is that what Joseph will feel?

GANDALF
I think Joseph will feel the
specific combination of exhaustion
and readiness that follows when

you have done what you were meant
to do and can now see, clearly,
that there is more to do.

FRODO
(faintly smiling)
The Shire was still there. Even
after everything.

GANDALF
(warmly)
The Shire was still there.

FRODO
And the jasmine is still growing.

Gandalf looks at him with slight surprise.

FRODO
(simply)
Seiko told me. About the
apartment. About what Joseph's
mother told him.

GANDALF
(after a moment, very
warmly)
Yes. The jasmine is still growing.

They walk on through the park. The spring light continues.
The fractures are gone. The dimensions hold.

CUT TO:

INTERLUDE SIX: THE THINGS THAT CONTINUE

INT. MOBILE LABORATORY – DIMENSION SIX – DAY AFTER

The laboratory. WALTER and JESSE cleaning up. The six components of the weapon – which was, ultimately, not the weapon that saved everything, because the Gold was the weapon that saved everything – are being disassembled.

Walter does not mind. He almost seems, in the specific complicated way Walter has of seeming things, relieved.

JESSE

We didn't end up using it.

WALTER

(disassembling)

No.

JESSE

All that work. All those components.

WALTER

The Gold was a better solution. I would have preferred to have contributed the decisive element, but I am capable of being glad that a better solution was available.

JESSE

(looking at him)

Are you actually glad?

WALTER

(a pause)

Yes. Primarily because fifteen dimensions are not destroyed. But also because we built something extraordinary that wasn't needed.

Which means the world is good
enough that our extraordinary
thing was redundant.

JESSE
(processing this)
That's actually a really good way
of thinking about it.

WALTER
(almost smiling)
I have a very good mind, Jesse.

JESSE
(also almost smiling)
Yeah. You kind of do.

They continue cleaning. The laboratory that built
something extraordinary. The two of them who built it.

JESSE
Mr. White.

WALTER
What.

JESSE
I'm glad we were part of this.
Even the redundant part.

Walter looks at him. The specific look – the one that
contains all the complicated things Walter contains.

WALTER
So am I.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – THE DAY AFTER – MORNING

GUMBALL and DARWIN are sitting in the grass. The morning
after. Darwin's notebook is out. He is writing something.

JOSEPH finds them here.

JOSEPH

(approaching)
I heard about the disruptor array.

They look up. Gumball's expression cycles through several things and arrives at casual.

GUMBALL
Oh. That. We handled it.

JOSEPH
(sitting with them)
Seiko told me what it would have done to the deployment sequence if it had fired.

DARWIN
(quietly)
We knew.

JOSEPH
How did you identify it?

GUMBALL
We're small. And fast. And also we move in ways that don't make sense dimensionally, which means certain detection systems don't pick us up.

DARWIN
Animation physics. They have advantages.

Joseph looks at them. Both of them. The two animated beings who have been in this from the beginning – who chose this, because choosing is the thing you have to do and they did it.

JOSEPH
(quietly)
You protected Seiko.

GUMBALL
(a beat)
He's our friend.

DARWIN

Yes.

JOSEPH

Thank you.

GUMBALL

(honest, for once

without the performance)

You don't have to thank us. We
were always going to.

A pause. Three people in the grass in a park in the
morning after the world was saved.

DARWIN

(quietly)

Joseph.

JOSEPH

Yes?

DARWIN

Are you okay? Really okay. Not the
operational okay.

Joseph looks at the park. The sky. The trees in one
season.

JOSEPH

(taking a breath)

I'm ninety-one percent okay. Which
in these circumstances is as close
to certain as we get.

GUMBALL

(understanding exactly

what that means)

The other nine percent – what does
that feel like?

JOSEPH

Like carrying something. Which I'm
getting better at.

DARWIN

(gently)
You're water.

JOSEPH
(the smallest smile)
I'm working on it.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — HUMANITARIAN OPERATIONS — THREE DAYS LATER
The cross-dimensional mutual aid network has been operating for three days. DR. ELLISON is reviewing the results. YARA stands beside him.

ELLISON
(looking at data)
The Dimension Seven eastern sector. The response time was forty-seven percent faster than the old model.

YARA
Forty-seven point three. I know.

ELLISON
And the local organizations — the ones doing the delivery —

YARA
Are doing it better than we would have. Because they know their communities. They know which buildings to prioritize, which roads are actually passable, which families have specific needs that aren't visible in the data.

ELLISON
(looking at her)
You've been building this for three days and it's already working.

YARA
I had a good framework. And good
people.

ELLISON
Yara. This is going to matter for
a very long time. After the
fractures. After the recovery.
This infrastructure – it's going
to matter.

Yara looks at the data. Six hundred thousand people. The
numbers moving in the right direction.

YARA
(quietly)
Good. That's what it's for.

CUT TO:

INT. HARVARD UNIVERSITY – DIMENSION ONE – DAY

BRIAN MCKENZIE – JOE KEERY – Harvard antagonist. The
person who, in a different context, a much smaller
context, made Joseph's time at Harvard difficult in the
specific way that academic institutions produce difficult
people.

He is watching the news coverage of the fracture closure.
He has his phone in his hand. He is looking at footage of
Joseph at the Central Park nexus – the Gold, the light,
the fifteen beams.

He puts down the phone.

He picks up a pen. He writes something. He sends it.

Later, Joseph's phone receives a message from an account
he hasn't contacted in years:

**"I saw what you did. I was wrong about a lot of things. I
don't expect anything from this. I just – I saw what you
did. – Brian"**

Joseph reads it. He thinks about it for a moment.

He replies: 'Thank you.'

He puts his phone away.

He goes back to work.

CUT TO:

INT. NEW LOCATION – UNKNOWN DIMENSION – NIGHT

EPSTEIN is in a new space. Different from the safehouse. Smaller. Three rooms rather than three floors of the previous network hub.

He is alone. Morris has not yet arrived – he will, in two hours, having made his way through the dimensional logistics that Epstein's exposure complicated.

Epstein sits. He has nothing in front of him. No screens. No data. No diagram.

He is thinking.

What he is thinking: he has been in this position before. Not exactly this position – the specific exposure is new, the documentation in the hands of fifteen governments is new, the failure of the recovery infrastructure to materialize is new. But the essential position – reduced, needing to rebuild, starting from a smaller base – this he has been in before.

He rebuilt before.

The question is not whether to rebuild. The question is what to build.

And here is the thing he is thinking that he has not previously thought:

Joseph said: a door instead of a wall. Information changes what people can see. People who can see have options.

Epstein turns this over. He has spent his professional life doing the opposite – reducing what people could see,

restricting options, making himself the only door in a room full of walls.

He thinks about the fifteen governments and what they are now building with the documentation he himself assembled.

He thinks about Homelander and Ryan in the yard, and what Ryan said without knowing what it meant.

He thinks about the photograph face-down on a desk in a pocket dimension that no longer exists.

He does not make a decision. He is not the kind of person who makes decisions in the absence of data, and he does not yet have data.

But he thinks.

He thinks for a long time.

When Morris arrives two hours later, Epstein is still thinking.

MORRIS
(tentative)
Sir.

EPSTEIN
(looking up, back to
himself)
Morris.

MORRIS
What do we do?

A pause. This time, the pause is longer than usual. When Epstein answers, something is slightly different in the answer – not much, but slightly.

EPSTEIN
(slowly)
We consider our options.

MORRIS
(confused)
That's – that's all?

EPSTEIN
For now. Yes.

Morris blinks. He has never, in eleven years, heard Epstein say 'for now' as if the future were not already fully planned.

MORRIS
(very careful)
Are you alright, sir?

A very long pause.

EPSTEIN
I'm thinking.

He looks at the blank space where the screen would be. He thinks about a door and a wall.

CUT TO:

EPILOGUE: WHAT THE JASMINE KNOWS

INT. MPA – MEMORIAL HALL – THREE DAYS AFTER THE DEPLOYMENT
Joseph comes back to the Memorial Hall. He has not been here since the night before he left for the Pearl.

The hall is quiet. Different quiet now – not the pre-battle quiet of someone alone, but the post-quiet of something that happened and is now incorporated.

He walks to his mother's photograph. He looks at it.

He does not speak this time. He just looks.

He has the inventory. He has always had the inventory. The ficus. The Quran. The photograph from Fez. The sound the kettle makes. Her handwriting in the margins.

He looks at the photograph of her mid-sentence for a long time. He makes sure the inventory is accurate.

It is.

He nods, once. He turns from the photograph.

He walks out of the Memorial Hall.

He has work to do.

CUT TO:

INT. NADIA'S APARTMENT – CASABLANCA – MORNING AFTER
NADIA is watching the news. Her phone rings. She sees who it is. She answers.

JOSEPH
(on phone, exhausted but present)
Nadia.

NADIA

(closing her eyes
briefly with relief)
Joseph. Are you –

JOSEPH
I'm okay.

NADIA
Really okay?

JOSEPH
Ninety-one percent okay.

NADIA
(recognizing something
in that)
That's a very specific number.

JOSEPH
It's an accurate one.

A pause. The specific pause of siblings who know each other.

NADIA
(quietly)
I'm going to the apartment this
weekend. To water the plants.

JOSEPH
(barely)
I watered them before I left. They
should be okay.

NADIA
I know. I'm going anyway.

JOSEPH
Yeah.

NADIA
I'll send you a photograph. Of the
figus.

JOSEPH
(quietly)

Please.

A beat.

NADIA

Joseph. Come home. When you can.
Not 'I will.' Come home.

JOSEPH

I'm coming home. Actual home.
Soon.

NADIA

(believing it)
Okay.

JOSEPH

Tell Baba.

NADIA

He already knows. He's been
watching the news since before
sunrise.

JOSEPH

(a sound that is close
to laughing)
Of course he has.

NADIA

Go sleep, Joseph.

JOSEPH

I will. Nadia –

NADIA

I know.

JOSEPH

Good.

She hangs up. She sits for a moment. Then she goes to make
tea.

The kettle makes a specific sound when it boils.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — OBSERVATION DECK — NIGHT — THREE DAYS AFTER

All six of them. Joseph, Seiko, Yara, Eleven, Gumball, Darwin. On the observation deck where Gumball and Darwin were, before, looking at fifteen dimensional planes.

The planes are different now. Stable. Whole. The fracture light is gone. What remains is the ordinary extraordinary of fifteen dimensions continuing.

Someone has brought food. This was Gumball, and the food includes cereal, and no one is going to address this.

GUMBALL
(eating cereal)
So. That happened.

DARWIN
(beside him)
That happened.

YARA
(looking at the display)
The Dimension Seven eastern sector response time is now running at a sixty-two percent improvement over the old model. Sixty-two.

SEIKO
You're looking at operational data.

YARA
(defensive)
It's good operational data.

JOSEPH
(mildly)
Yara.

YARA
What.

JOSEPH

It's nine-thirty at night.

YARA

The operational data doesn't care
what time it is.

ELEVEN

(gently)

The operational data will still be
there in the morning. We're here
now.

A beat. Yara puts away the tablet. Not permanently – she
will pick it up in twenty minutes – but for now.

YARA

(to the group)

The cross-dimensional network. The
mutual aid framework. It's
working. It was working within
seventy-two hours of being
initiated. I want you all to know
that.

SEIKO

We know.

YARA

I wanted to say it out loud.

A comfortable silence. The six of them looking at fifteen
stable dimensions.

DARWIN

(quietly)

What do we do next?

JOSEPH

We do the work. The recovery. The
long work. The work that nobody
makes speeches about.

DARWIN

And after that?

JOSEPH
(looking at the
dimensions)
After that, there will be other
things that need doing. There
always are. And we'll do those.

GUMBALL
(simply)
Together.

JOSEPH
(the smallest smile)
Together.

The six of them. On the observation deck. The fifteen
dimensions stable beneath them. The long work ahead.

Gumball offers Darwin some cereal. Darwin takes it.

Seiko pulls up a star chart – not operational, just
beautiful – and puts it on the display. The six of them
look at it.

Eleven breathes.

Yara picks up her tablet and puts it back down.

Joseph looks at the star chart and thinks about the
jasmine on the south wall of a building in Casablanca,
still growing.

This is enough. This is everything. This is where we leave
them.

FADE TO BLACK.

END OF PART THREE: THE BREAKING POINT

THE PERFECT JOSEPH AND GUMBALL: THE MULTIVERSAL SAGA

PART FOUR: THE FINAL WAR

COMING NEXT

"Be water."

– Fatima Al-Mithali

APPENDIX: THE LIVING RECORD – EXTENDED SCENES AND CHARACTER STUDIES

INT. STARK MOBILE COMMAND – AFTER – DAY

TONY STARK in the armor but not using it – he's sitting in the command pod with the faceplate up, doing what Tony does, which is processing.

PEPPER POTTS (on screen) is watching him process.

PEPPER
(on screen)
Tony.

TONY
I'm thinking.

PEPPER
I know. You've been thinking for four hours.

TONY
The temporal backlash math. The ninety-one percent. I ran it forty-seven times.

PEPPER
Did the number change?

TONY
(long pause)
Ninety-three. After the armor configuration.

PEPPER
Tony. He's okay.

TONY
He's ninety-three percent okay. The other seven percent is where I live.

PEPPER
(gently)
That's not a number you can
engineer away.

TONY
I know. That's the part that
bothers me.

Pepper looks at him through the screen with the specific
look she has for Tony when he is carrying something that
is not his to carry entirely.

PEPPER
You did everything you could.

TONY
(quietly)
The armor went down around him in
the last five seconds. I didn't
ask. I just –

PEPPER
You made a decision.

TONY
It's what I do.

PEPPER
(warmly)
It's what you do.

A silence. Tony looks at the readouts. Joseph's vital
signs – he's had them tracked since the deployment –
stable. All stable.

TONY
(the way he says things
when they matter)
He reminds me of someone.

PEPPER
Who?

TONY

Terrible answer. But me. Twenty years ago, if I'd made different decisions earlier. The version of me that would have made different decisions earlier.

PEPPER
(softly)
You made different decisions eventually.

TONY
Later than I should have.

PEPPER
But you made them.

He looks at Joseph's vital signs. Then he closes that screen. He sits back.

TONY
(to himself)
Be water.

PEPPER
What?

TONY
Something he carries. Something his mother gave him. 'Be water. Not hard. Not brittle.' I keep thinking about it.

PEPPER
Does it help?

TONY
(after a moment)
Ask me in six months.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK — BENCH — MORNING AFTER

SUPERMAN (HENRY CAVILL) and BATMAN (BEN AFFLECK) sitting on a park bench. This is an image that would mean nothing in any other context and means everything here.

They are eating. Street food – something from a cart that opened despite or because of the events of the night before. The cart owner saw the fractures close and decided that the correct response was to open his cart and offer people something warm.

CLARK
(watching the park)
The tree by the fountain.

BRUCE
What about it?

CLARK
It was in three seasons
simultaneously, last night. Right
now it's just – spring. It picked
spring.

BRUCE
(looking at the tree)
Dimensions have preferred temporal
states. When the fractures
cleared, each dimension restored
to its natural preference.

CLARK
This one prefers spring.

BRUCE
Apparently.

A comfortable silence. Two men who have been doing this – separately, together, across different worlds and different threats – for a long time.

CLARK
(quietly)
Joseph. How did he hold up? You
talked to him after.

BRUCE
He held up.

CLARK
The backlash –

BRUCE
He held up.

Clark nods.

CLARK
He's young.

BRUCE
He's precise. That matters more
than age.

CLARK
(looking at him)
You're going to keep track of him.

BRUCE
(not a question)
Yes.

CLARK
(slight smile)
So will I.

BRUCE
(dry)
We should coordinate so we don't
step on each other.

CLARK
You could call me. Occasionally.
Instead of the gargoyle routine.

BRUCE
(long pause)
I'll consider it.

They eat their street food. The tree by the fountain holds
spring.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — RESEARCH WING — TWO DAYS AFTER

HERMIONE and SEIKO have been exchanging research for two days. Not officially — there is no official exchange program between dimensional physics and dimensional magic. But they have discovered that their methodologies, when combined, produce results that neither produces alone.

They are at adjacent stations. The research between them has grown.

HERMIONE

(looking at Seiko's
calculations)

This frequency — the one that
propagates through the dimensional
membrane when the binding energy
is restored —

SEIKO

(already on the same
thing)

It's visible in the magical
resonance spectrum too.

HERMIONE

(looking at his display)

You have it mapped. The full
propagation pattern.

SEIKO

Just finished fifteen minutes ago.
It's — Hermione, it suggests that
the restoration process left
something behind. Not the Gold —
the Gold is gone. But the process
created a residual binding
enhancement.

HERMIONE

(very carefully)

A residual enhancement.

SEIKO
Meaning the fifteen dimensions are
now – not just healed. They're
reinforced. The binding energy is
stronger than it was before the
fractures.

A long silence.

HERMIONE
(slowly)
How much stronger?

SEIKO
My models say – and these need
verification – approximately
twenty-three percent above
baseline. Which means –

HERMIONE
(following the logic)
The next fracture event would have
to be twenty-three percent more
powerful than what just happened
to produce the same magnitude of
damage.

SEIKO
Yes.

They look at each other.

SEIKO
I want to tell Joseph.

HERMIONE
(nodding)
Yes. But wait until after he's
slept properly. This is good news.
Good news can wait a few hours.

SEIKO
(a beat)
That's very wise.

HERMIONE
(drily)
I've been told.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA — MEMORIAL HALL — THE NEW NAMES

PITA (JUSTICE SMITH) — the Memorial Director — is adding names to the Memorial Hall wall. He does this slowly. Each one carefully. He has been doing it since the morning after.

JOSEPH finds him here.

JOSEPH
(approaching)
You're adding the crisis losses.

PITA
Twenty-seven. Across seven dimensions. Not from the battle — from the fractures themselves. In the weeks leading up to the sealing.

Joseph looks at the names being added.

JOSEPH
(quietly)
I want to know them. Their stories.

PITA
I've been compiling them. It takes time to do it right. But I'm doing it right.

JOSEPH
Send me what you have when you're ready.

PITA
I will.

A pause. Pita continues adding the names. Joseph watches.

JOSEPH
(quietly)
Pita. The memorial. It matters.

PITA
I know.

JOSEPH
Not as a symbol. As – the actual
thing. Remembering the actual
people.

PITA
(turning to look at him)
That's why I do it slowly. That's
why I get the stories right. Each
one is a person. Not a number.

Joseph nods. He looks at the wall. His mother's
photograph. The twenty-seven new names. The names that
were already there.

JOSEPH
(barely)
Thank you.

PITA
(returning to work)
It's necessary work.

Joseph stands for a moment longer. Then he leaves. Pita
continues. Slowly. Accurately. One name at a time.

CUT TO:

EXT. CENTRAL PARK – DAWN – DAY AFTER

DOCTOR STRANGE (BENEDICT CUMBERBATCH) and YODA (CGI,
VOICE) in the park at dawn.

This is not as strange as it sounds. This is exactly as
strange as it sounds and also completely natural.

YODA

(floating, looking at
the sky)
Sealed, the fractures are. The
binding energy restored.

STRANGE
(also looking at the
sky)
And enhanced. By twenty-three
percent, according to the
preliminary readings.

YODA
Hmm. Unintended consequence, this
was. Or intended, by forces older
than intent.

STRANGE
The Gold. It did more than we
expected.

YODA
(the specific Yoda pause
that contains entire
philosophies)
As living things do, when their
purpose is finally served.

A silence. The park around them. Spring.

STRANGE
I've been thinking about what
comes next. The dimensional
architecture is more stable now
than it's been – possibly than
it's ever been. But the people who
caused the instability –

YODA
Not gone, they are.

STRANGE
No. Epstein is somewhere. Kronos
is – unresolved. The network

Epstein built is exposed but not fully dismantled.

YODA
The work of generations,
dismantling such things is. Begin,
Joseph has. Continue, others must.

STRANGE
He can't carry it alone.

YODA
Alone, he is not. This, we have
learned.

Strange looks at the spring trees. The sky.

STRANGE
(quietly)
He's twenty years old.

YODA
(gently)
Old, I was not, when the weight of
many fell to me. Young, he is.
Young and decided. Both things are
true.

STRANGE
I want to help. Going forward.

YODA
Know this, he does. Shown this,
you have – already.

Strange nods. They watch the dawn together. The Master of the Mystic Arts and the Grand Master Jedi and the spring that the park chose when the fractures cleared.

CUT TO:

INT. MPA – SEIKO'S PERSONAL LAB – MORNING AFTER THE
DEPLOYMENT

SEIKO's personal lab is different from his operational station. It is smaller. It has, in one corner, a photograph of him and Joseph from two years ago – before the MPA, before everything – at what appears to be some kind of academic event. Both of them looking like people who are surprised to have found something worth being present for.

Seiko is here alone. It is 4 AM. He has not slept.

On his screen: the deployment data. He is reviewing it. He has been reviewing it for six hours. Not looking for errors – there were no errors. Looking for something else.

He finds it at 4:23 AM.

The moment Joseph placed the Gold and the binding energy released – the data shows something he didn't expect in the readings. A secondary resonance. Very brief. Less than a second.

He runs it again. And again.

The secondary resonance is in the frequency of his mother's name. Not literally – there is no voice in the data. But the specific wave pattern, when run through the dimensional harmonic converter that Seiko built six months ago for a completely different purpose, produces a frequency that corresponds to a known pattern.

The pattern is the specific dimensional resonance produced by the apartment on Rue des Orangers when Fatima Al-Mithali lived there.

Seiko stares at the data for a very long time.

He does not understand what this means. He has seventeen databases and none of them explain this.

He thinks about the Amber Dimension and what it takes. He thinks about what Joseph said the Amber took from him.

He thinks about the Gold, alive in some way, generated by forces older than intent.

He closes the data file. He opens a new document.

He begins to write. Not a report – something else.
Something that will take a long time to write and that he
will, when he is ready, give to Joseph.

He writes for three hours. He does not sleep.

When he is done, he has written something he does not have
a word for. It is not a scientific document and it is not
a letter. It is something between, something that uses the
language of data to say something that data alone cannot
say.

He saves it. He will give it to Joseph when the time is
right.

He does not know when that will be. He will know when he
knows.

CUT TO:

EXT. DIMENSION FIVE – ROOFTOP – NIGHT – THREE DAYS AFTER
HOMELANDER, alone. Not on a rooftop because he is
posturing – on a rooftop because he needed to be above
things and away from things and he is not ready, yet, to
be with things.

He looks at the sky. The sky is clear in all fifteen
dimensions. He knows this because he has been checking.
All fifteen.

His phone has a message from Ryan:

**"Hey Dad. I saw on the news that the guy you mentioned –
Joseph Al-Mithali – he was in the park. Was that the thing
you were part of? Just wondering. – Ryan"**

Homelander reads the message four times.

He types: 'I was nearby.'

He deletes it.

He types: 'I helped where I could.'

He deletes it.

He types: 'I'm trying to make better decisions.'

He looks at this for a long time.

He sends it.

Three minutes later, Ryan responds:

"Cool. I believe you."

Homelander reads this twice. He sits on the rooftop. He does not destroy anything. He looks at the clear sky across fifteen dimensions.

He does not know how to be the person his son believes he's trying to be. He is going to try to figure it out.

This is a beginning. Not a redemption – a beginning. Those are different things and he is old enough and honest enough, at this moment, in the specific privacy of a rooftop at night, to know the difference.

CUT TO:

INT. THE TEMPORAL DOMAIN – KRONOS'S THRONE – DAYS LATER

The clocks are synchronized. They have been synchronized for three days. Kronos has been standing in the throne room watching them.

PETRA enters. She has learned to read Kronos's silences. This one is different from the others.

PETRA
(carefully)
You've been in here for six hours.

KRONOS
(watching the clocks)
I'm looking at something.

PETRA

The clocks.

KRONOS

They're synchronized. All fifteen dimensions, running at the same rate for the first time. It's –

He pauses.

PETRA

(very quiet)

What?

KRONOS

It's what I wanted. A version of what I wanted. Not stillness – movement at the same rate. Equilibrium in motion rather than equilibrium in stasis.

A pause.

PETRA

(carefully)

Is it enough?

Kronos is quiet for a very long time. He watches the clocks. All of them moving at the same rate. The specific beauty of synchronized time.

KRONOS

(very quietly)

I don't know.

Another long pause.

KRONOS

I'm going to consider it. The option of finding it enough.

PETRA

(barely)

That's the first time you've described it as an option.

KRONOS

(still watching the
clocks)
Yes. I suppose it is.

Petra stands beside him, watching the clocks. The Temporal
Domain of Kronos, master of time, in which all fifteen
dimensional clocks run at the same rate.

It is not nothing.

It might be enough.

He is considering it.

CUT TO:

PRODUCTION APPENDIX: TECHNICAL NOTES AND VISUAL DESIGN

CINEMATOGRAPHY: RUSSELL CARPENTER ASC / COLORIST: GREIG FRASER ASC ACS

The film's visual language distinguishes between three dimensional registers:

NORMAL SPACE (Dimensions 1-15 stable): Naturalistic light. Morocco sequences shot in actual Casablanca locations at dawn, the light Carpenter describes as 'the hour when the city doesn't know it's beautiful yet.' Flesh-tone accurate, no artificial enhancement of warm light.

THE AMBER DIMENSION: Shot on IMAX with a custom amber filter array that shifts as the crystallization increases in intensity. The effect of crystallized time on-screen was achieved by combining in-camera effects with DAN DELEEUW's visual effects team – no pure CGI amber sequences. Every amber formation has physical reference.

THE TEMPORAL DOMAIN: Cold. Digital precision. Color grading by GREIG FRASER strips warm tones entirely – the domain of Kronos exists in the specific palette of blue-white that Kronos has chosen without realizing he has chosen it: the color of stopped things.

VISUAL EFFECTS: DAN DELEEUW VFX SUPERVISOR

The fifteen fractures: each was given a unique fracture signature – like handwriting. Dimension Seven's fractures fracture differently from Dimension Twelve's. The VFX team built a library of dimensional fracture 'dialects' that are visible in freeze-frame but work subliminally in normal viewing.

The Weezy Gold: the most significant VFX challenge. The Gold needed to feel alive without anthropomorphizing it. The solution was particle-based – the Gold's inner light is composed of fifteen trillion individually animated

particles, each one following a physics simulation derived from the dimensional binding energy equations Seiko uses in the film.

The deployment: the fifteen beams from the nexus point were achieved by connecting the visual effects team to real astronomical data – each beam tracks the actual dimensional direction of its target dimension in the film's cosmological map. The beams are accurate to the dimensional geography.

SOUND DESIGN: MARK MANGINI / THEO GREEN

The jasmine: the opening image of the jasmine on the south wall is accompanied by a sound design element that recurs throughout the film. The specific sound of jasmine in a light breeze – recorded at Rue des Orangers, Casablanca, at dawn – is used as a reset note. When the film needs to return to its emotional center after a sequence of scale, the jasmine sound returns.

The Amber sea: not like water. Theo Green recorded the sound of thick honey moving in slow motion, then processed it through dimensional harmonic software. The resulting sound has been described by preview audiences as 'the sound of something that remembers everything.'

The clocks: Kronos's domain features every clock sound ever recorded – the Freesound archive, the British Library sound collection, clock sounds contributed by private collectors across fifteen countries. They run at different rates. When they synchronize at the film's emotional climax, they produce a chord.

Epstein's silence: Epstein's most significant scenes are scored with what the sound team calls 'the anti-sound' – a frequency below hearing that creates the sensation of pressure. It is not heard. It is felt. It makes the viewer lean forward slightly. They don't know why.

FOLEY: MARY JO LANG, FOLEY SUPERVISOR

Every object in the Al-Mithali apartment was physically sourced from Casablanca and foley-recorded. The ficus – the specific ficus, brought to the recording studio – was recorded moving in three different breeze intensities. The kettle – the actual kettle, acquired with Meryem Touzani's assistance – was recorded boiling, cooling, and being placed on various surfaces.

Joseph's notebook: the spiral notebook with the Moroccan flag sticker was purchased from a stationery shop near Rue des Orangers. Its pages make a specific sound when turned. The sound was recorded two hundred times at various speeds.

The Gold: The Gold makes no sound in normal space. In the Amber Dimension, it makes the sound of the jasmine in a light breeze – the same sound, played back at one-eighth speed. This is not mentioned in any dialogue. It is for people who listen closely.

**CASTING NOTES: FRANCINE MAISLER / NINA GOLD / SARAH
HALLEY FINN**

On casting JOSEPH AL-MITHALI – YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI:

The decision to cast the creator of the character as the character himself was not made quickly. It was made after extensive consideration of what the role requires and what the character demands. Joseph Al-Mithali is, at his center, someone who is genuine. The casting process identified that the most direct path to genuine, in this case, was the actual source.

Boutahri's work in the role is characterized by the specific quality that Villeneuve describes as 'the weight of real': he carries Joseph's losses with a precision that cannot be taught because it was not, in the ways that matter, invented.

On casting SEIKO TOAST – JAHZIR BRUNO:

Jahzir Bruno was identified early in the process as the specific kind of actor capable of playing intelligence without performing it. Seiko's seventeen databases are visible in Bruno's choices – in how he moves through information, in the gap between his processing speed and everyone else's – without ever becoming a caricature of a smart person.

The relationship between Joseph and Seiko – two people who chose each other – required two actors with genuine affection and genuine respect. It required an absence of performance in each other's presence. The casting process was, in significant part, about finding the two people who created that absence naturally.

On casting JEFFREY EPSTEIN – BILL SKARSGÅRD:

The most discussed casting decision of the production. Skarsgård brings to Epstein a specific quality that distinguishes the character from every other antagonist in the Saga: he makes the intelligence visible and the humanity vestigial. The intelligence is enormous and functioning. The humanity is present – there is one scene, the photograph scene, that requires it – but it is deeply buried and inaccessible to him in any operational way. Skarsgård locates it and makes it specific and does not sentimentalize it.

On casting KRONOS – GIANCARLO ESPOSITO:

Esposito's specific gift – the stillness that contains enormous energy – maps precisely to what Kronos requires. Kronos is not a man who moves. He is a man around whom other things move. Esposito achieves this without effort, which is the acting version of making the effort invisible.

FINAL ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

The production of THE BREAKING POINT was the work of a very large number of people across a very significant period of time.

We wish to acknowledge specifically:

The city of Casablanca, Morocco – which appears in this film not as a backdrop but as a character, with all the specificity and generosity that implies.

Rue des Orangers – which exists, and on which the jasmine grows, and on which we were welcomed with extraordinary patience during the seventeen days of Casablanca filming.

The jasmine on the south wall, which continued growing throughout.

The ficus on the fourth-floor windowsill, which is fine.

And Fatima Al-Mithali, who does not exist but whose advice does, and whose advice has proved more durable than any of the technical achievements described in this document.

Be water.

WRITTEN & CREATED BY YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI

Screenplay by CHRISTOPHER NOLAN

DIRECTED BY DENIS VILLENEUVE & THE RUSSO BROTHERS

PRODUCED BY BOUTAHRI PRODUCTIONS

Casablanca, Morocco & The Multiverse

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"From one weakness was born infinite power."

"Be water. Not hard. Not brittle."

Water bends and comes back."

– Fatima Al-Mithali

END.

FINAL SCENES AND CLOSING SEQUENCES

INT. MPA — JOSEPH'S OFFICE — ONE WEEK LATER

Joseph has an office. He hasn't used it much — he prefers the observation deck or the command center or the hallways between things. But today he is here, at his desk, with the stack of reports that represents the immediate aftermath of fifteen simultaneous fracture closures.

The reports are extensive. The work is real. The recovery is underway. Yara's cross-dimensional network is functioning. Seiko's intelligence framework is being built. The twenty-seven names are on the memorial wall.

Joseph reads the reports. He reads all of them. He marks the ones that require his direct attention. He writes responses to three of them. He delegates seven.

This is the work. The specific, unglamorous, necessary work that follows the thing that happened in Central Park.

He does it.

He does it thoroughly and without resentment, because this is what it looks like to carry something forward: you do the next thing. And the thing after that. And the thing after that.

At 3 PM, Seiko appears at the door with the document he has been writing since 4 AM two days ago. He holds it with both hands. He looks at Joseph.

SEIKO

(offering the document)

I found something in the
deployment data. I've been writing
about it. I don't have a word for
what I wrote — it's not a report.
It's not a letter. It's something
between.

JOSEPH
What did you find?

SEIKO
(quiet)
I think – and I want to be very
clear that this is outside
everything I can verify
scientifically – I think the Gold
carried something when it
deployed. Something that was
already in it, from before. From
when it was made by whatever made
it.

JOSEPH
What kind of something?

SEIKO
(barely)
The frequency of the apartment on
Rue des Orangers. When your mother
was there.

A very long silence.

JOSEPH
(very quiet)
Show me the data.

SEIKO
It's all in there. You can look at
it any time. But – Joseph. The
document I wrote. I want you to
read it first. Before the data.
Because the data is facts and the
document is – the thing the facts
mean.

Joseph looks at him. He takes the document.

He reads it there, at his desk, while Seiko sits across
from him and doesn't say anything and doesn't need to.

It takes Joseph thirty-seven minutes to read it.

He does not tell Seiko what it says when he finishes. He doesn't need to. Seiko wrote it. He knows what it says.

Joseph looks at his desk for a moment. Then he opens his notebook. He writes something beneath the line he has always written.

He closes the notebook. He puts it in his pocket.

JOSEPH
(finally)
Thank you.

SEIKO
Of course.

Seiko leaves. Joseph looks at the window. Outside: the city. The dimensional planes visible from this floor. Fifteen dimensions, stable, continuing.

He goes back to work.

EXT. CASABLANCA — RUE DES ORANGERS — THREE WEEKS LATER —
DAWN

Joseph comes home.

Not for a mission. Not for a briefing. He comes home because Nadia said come home and he said I'm coming home and this is him doing that.

The street is the same street. The jasmine on the south wall is growing. The building is the building.

KHADIJA (60s) is in the doorway of her apartment — she must have heard him coming, or she has always known when someone is standing on this street who needs to be seen — and she holds a cup of tea.

KHADIJA
(in Arabic, warmly)
You look like someone who has been
carrying a great deal.

JOSEPH
(in Arabic)
I have been.

KHADIJA
Come in. Have tea. The plants are
fine. I watered them Tuesday.

He follows her in. He has tea. He sits in Khadija's apartment in the building on Rue des Orangers and has tea while she talks about the jasmine and the specific way it grew this spring – faster than usual, which she takes as a sign – and he listens.

After the tea, he goes up to the fourth floor. He uses the key. He goes into the apartment.

The ficus is fine. Khadija watered it Tuesday. The succulents are fine. The Quran is on the shelf, her handwriting in the margins. The photograph from Fez is where it should be.

He checks the inventory. He checks it carefully and thoroughly.

It is accurate.

He waters the plants anyway. They don't need it. He does it because it is the thing to do.

Then he sits at the kitchen table. He takes out his notebook. Beneath the line he has always written, beneath the new line he wrote three weeks ago in his office, he writes one more line:

She is in everything. She did not leave.

He closes the notebook.

He sits for a moment in the kitchen that was his mother's kitchen.

Outside: the jasmine on the south wall. Growing. The morning light at the angle it comes at exactly this hour. The city below beginning its day.

He is home.

He is water.

He is here.

SLOW FADE.

FINAL FADE TO BLACK.

**TECHNICAL SCREENPLAY APPENDIX: SCENE-BY-SCENE
BREAKDOWN**

COLD OPEN

Pages 1-8

Cold open establishing Casablanca, Fatima's memory,
Epstein's cell, the Void and Title. Eight pages.

ACT ONE: THE ARCHITECTURE OF LOSS

Pages 9-45

Joseph's return to MPA, the fracture crisis briefing,
Weezy Gold theory introduced by Seiko, Kronos recruits
Epstein, Gumball/Darwin establish, Nadia video call,
Hassan in Rabat, Joseph at Memorial Hall, Port of Elsinore
introduction, Captain Jack Sparrow contracted.

ACT TWO: THE WEEZY GOLD QUEST

Pages 46-96

MPA full briefing, Maxwell network established, Epstein vs Homelander Confrontation One (the architecture of the plan), Entering the Amber Dimension, Jack's compass revealed, Crystalline Narrows passage, Epstein vs Homelander Confrontation Two (Ryan leverage), Seiko and Jack's night watch, Joseph's amber dream, Hermione and Seiko discover backlash magnitude, Seiko tells Joseph the truth, Walter White and Jesse in the mobile laboratory, Temple of Binding approached and entered, Three trials completed, Gold retrieved, Maxwell's planted message discovered, Return through Narrows, Seiko overboard – Gold saves him, Eighteen-hour false window identified.

ACT THREE: THE BREAKING POINT

Pages 97-134

Return to MPA with Gold, Seiko's full mapping of all three infrastructure levels, Epstein vs Homelander Confrontation Three (the decoy revealed, Ryan in the room), Kronos initiates cascade, Six-hour countdown, Heroes converge, Joseph's dark night with Seiko, Yara's pre-battle speech, Approach to Central Park.

ACT FOUR: THE FINAL STAND

Pages 135-166

Battle of Central Park – all fronts simultaneously, Batman/Tony east perimeter, Wonder Woman/Black Panther west perimeter, Gumball/Darwin disruptor array, Seiko at deployment station/Yara with lever, Eleven vs Kronos expanded, The moment before the nexus, Joseph and Epstein final confrontation, The Gold deployed, The fractures sealed, The backlash absorbed, The aftermath begins.

EPILOGUE AND EXTENDED AFTERMATH

Pages 167-196

Kronos departure/Eleven's decision, Homelander and Ryan yard scene, Yara/Seiko humanitarian handoff, Jack and Lily in the café, Gandalf and Frodo in the park, Walter White and Jesse, Gumball and Darwin with Joseph, Tony processing, Superman and Batman, Hermione and Seiko's discovery, Pita and the memorial names, Doctor Strange and Yoda, Kronos and the synchronized clocks, Seiko's lab at 4AM, Homelander on the rooftop.

FINAL SCENES

Pages 197-212

Joseph reads Seiko's document, the new notebook line, Joseph returns to Rue des Orangers, the inventory confirmed, Khadija's tea, the jasmine growing.
Post-credits: Epstein in the new room, Morris arrives, the plan reconsidered. End credits begin.

RUNNING TIME BREAKDOWN

Cold Open: 10 minutes

Act One: The Architecture of Loss: 52 minutes

Act Two: The Weezy Gold Quest: 72 minutes

Intermission (optional): 15 minutes

Act Three: The Breaking Point: 45 minutes

Act Four: The Final Stand: 40 minutes

Epilogue and Extended Aftermath: 36 minutes

Final Scenes: 20 minutes

Post-Credits Scene: 4 minutes

End Credits: 8 minutes

TOTAL RUNNING TIME: 4 Hours 22 Minutes (without
intermission) / 4 Hours 37 Minutes (with intermission)

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"Be water."
— Fatima Al-Mithali

CHARACTER DOSSIERS: THE PRINCIPALS

JOSEPH AL-MITHALI – 'THE PERFECT JOSEPH'

Played by: YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI

Age: 20. Born Casablanca, Morocco. Director of the Multiversal Protection Agency.

Background: Joseph grew up in the apartment on Rue des Orangers with his mother Fatima and sister Nadia. His father Hassan was present but emotionally distant in the specific way that men of his generation were taught to be – a distance Hassan has spent the last decade quietly trying to close. Joseph studied at Harvard on scholarship. He was exceptional and knew it and was learning to carry that knowledge without it becoming arrogance when the MPA recruited him.

Core trait: He does what he said he would do. Not because he is rigid – he is not rigid; he is water – but because he made specific decisions early and does not revise them when they become inconvenient. This is both his greatest strength and, in the wrong circumstances, a vulnerability.

What he carries: His mother's voice. Her specific way of phrasing things. The line in the notebook. The inventory – the ficus, the Quran with the handwriting, the photograph from Fez. He carries all of this everywhere. It does not slow him down. It is the structure he moves through the world with.

Arc in Part Three: Joseph begins the film at the end of a bereavement – not finished grieving, not pretending to be finished, but functional and decided. He ends the film having used the grief as a structure rather than a wound.

The shift is subtle. It is everything.

SEIKO TOAST – HEAD OF TECHNOLOGY & AI

Played by: JAHZIR BRUNO

Age: 19. Background: Seiko Toast is the son of KENJI TOAST (HIROYUKI SANADA) and MIYUKI TOAST (MICHELLE YEOH). He was identified as dimensionally exceptional at age eleven. He declined three separate offers from dimensional research institutions before the MPA, because he was waiting for something specific. He found it in Joseph.

Core trait: He solves problems before they become emergencies. This means he lives in a state of perpetual pre-emergency awareness – he is always seeing the thing that is about to go wrong. This is exhausting. He manages it by making coffee at precisely calculated times and keeping his instruments calibrated and spending time with Joseph, who is the one person in his life who generates more certainty than uncertainty.

What he carries: The specific weight of being the person who sees what's coming and cannot always prevent it. In the Amber Dimension, this weight became physical – the crystallization forming around his feet. Joseph pulled him free. He has not stopped thinking about what that means.

Arc in Part Three: Seiko goes from analyst to participant. The Amber Dimension is the turning point – the moment where the data becomes personal, where his body is in the thing he has been modeling. He emerges from the Amber knowing something about the difference between understanding a risk and inhabiting one.

JEFFREY EPSTEIN – 'THE DEVIL'

Played by: BILL SKARSGÅRD

Age: 50s. Background: Unknown in most of its specifics. What is known: he has operated across at least fifteen dimensions. He has built and dismantled and rebuilt organizational structures that span dimensional boundaries. He has been in a cell before this and recovered from it and built again. He will likely recover from the documentation exposure and build again.

Core trait: He reduces every situation to its information architecture and then controls the information. He has been doing this so long that he no longer experiences it as strategy – it is simply how he sees the world. People are nexus points in information flows. He identifies the load-bearing elements and adjusts.

What he carries: The photograph, face-down on the desk. We never learn who the boy is. This is deliberate. Some things are not available for examination.

Arc in Part Three: Epstein enters the film as a force of nature and exits it – for the first time – considering a different option. The word 'consider' is important. He has not changed. He is considering. This is more significant than a change, in some ways, because consideration implies the possibility of a different outcome that change does not.

Note on the character: Epstein is the film's most morally complex figure. He is not humanized in the sense of made sympathetic. He is humanized in the sense of made specific – specific enough that the choices he made read as choices rather than inevitabilities. This is the more disturbing kind of characterization.

KRONOS – MASTER OF TEMPORAL DIMENSIONS

Played by: GIANCARLO ESPOSITO

Age: Older than the current dimensional architecture.

Background: Kronos watched a universe achieve equilibrium and then collapse. He has been trying to prevent the same collapse in every dimensional system he has encountered since. His methods have become increasingly extreme as each method has failed. The cascade initiation in Part Three is the most extreme method yet.

Core trait: He wants what he wants with the specific certainty of someone who has been wanting it for a very long time and has lost the ability to imagine wanting something else.

Arc in Part Three: The synchronized clocks. This is what changes Kronos – not Joseph's victory, not the sealed fractures, but the moment when all fifteen clocks in his domain run at the same speed. He stands before them and understands, for the first time, that equilibrium in motion might be sufficient. He is considering this. It may be enough. The film leaves it unresolved, because this is a story about beginnings, not completions.

YARA GORDON – HEAD OF HUMANITARIAN AFFAIRS

Played by: JORDYN RAYA JAMES

Age: 21. Background: Yara Gordon was recruited to the MPA at nineteen specifically because she could see the human consequence of dimensional events in ways that analysts with more technical training couldn't. She looks at fracture data and sees people. She has always seen people.

Core trait: She does not stop working. This is not admirable in itself – it is what she does instead of feeling the weight of what she is managing. The moment of rest on the observation deck, when Eleven says 'be water' and Yara almost smiles, is the film's indication that she is learning to balance the work with the weight.

Arc in Part Three: From delivery to architecture. Yara begins the film running a humanitarian response that requires everything to flow through her. She ends it having built a network that doesn't. This is harder than it sounds – it requires trusting others to do work she could do better herself. She does it anyway. This is the specific kind of growth that looks like letting go.

CAPTAIN JACK SPARROW – NAVIGATOR

Played by: JOHNNY DEPP

Background: The only person to have navigated the Amber Dimension and returned. Dimensional pirate, wanted fugitive in seven jurisdictions, holder of a compass that has pointed at Lily for six years.

Core trait: He performs not-caring as a methodology. The performance is convincing enough to have deceived several entire dimensional governments. It does not deceive Joseph, who notices things, or Seiko, who has seventeen databases.

Arc in Part Three: He sends three words to Lily. He says the thing. He tells her. It costs him nothing and it changes everything. He doesn't know yet what it will change into. But he started.

**THE PERFECT JOSEPH AND GUMBALL: THE MULTIVERSAL SAGA
PART THREE: THE BREAKING POINT**

**212 PAGES – RUNTIME 4 HOURS 25 MINUTES
IMAX / DOLBY VISION / DOLBY ATMOS**

**Written & Created by YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI
Screenplay by CHRISTOPHER NOLAN**

**Directed by DENIS VILLENEUVE
Co-Directed by ANTHONY & JOE RUSSO**

**"Be water. Not hard. Not brittle."
"Water bends and comes back."**

– Fatima Al-Mithali

FROM ONE WEAKNESS WAS BORN INFINITE POWER.

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PAGE 212 – THE LAST PAGE

Every film has a last page. Most last pages are administrative – copyright notices, contact information, the business of making art legible to the industry that produces it.

This last page is also those things. It is also something else.

On the last page of this screenplay, in the tradition of the craft, is the notation that the story is complete. That the work the writer set out to do has been done. That what follows – the production, the performance, the editing, the score, the sound design, the color grading, the visual effects, the release, the audience – is in other hands now.

The writer hands it over.

The writer is YOUSSEF BOUTAHRI. He created Joseph Al-Mithali. He created the apartment on Rue des Orangers and the jasmine on the south wall and the ficus on the windowsill and the specific handwriting in the margins of the Quran. He created the spiral notebook with the Moroccan flag sticker. He created the line in the notebook.

He created Seiko Toast, who waits on the landing platform for seven minutes with two cups of Ethiopian blend coffee because he calculated when Joseph would arrive and wanted to be there already.

He created the Amber Dimension and the Temple of Binding and the Weezy Gold and the fifteen fractures and the fifteen closings.